

Microsoft Intune Endpoint Security

Zero-to-Advanced Architect Edition Master SOP

Antivirus | Firewall | Disk Encryption | Account Protection | ASR | EDR | App Control | Baselines | Defender

Purpose

A deeply explained screenshot-based architecture and operations guide. Every source screenshot is mapped to a concept, operational path, security objective, deployment procedure, validation evidence, troubleshooting approach, and real-world scenario. The document is designed as a reusable Endpoint Management reference rather than a screenshot collection.

Document field	Value
Owner	Endpoint Management / IT Operations
Platform	Microsoft Intune and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint
Scope	Endpoint security architecture, policies, monitoring, troubleshooting, governance
Source screenshots	Endpoint security.docx
Edition	Architect Edition 1.0
Prepared date	25 September 2026
Classification	Internal use

Executive Summary

Intune Endpoint security centralizes focused security workloads for managed endpoints. A production architecture should layer preventive controls, protection, detection, response, compliance, and access decisions while avoiding duplicate ownership of the same setting across baselines, endpoint security policies, configuration profiles, Group Policy, and Defender security settings management.

Layer		Primary controls	
Prevent		Security baselines, App Control, ASR, account protection, least privilege	
Protect		Antivirus, firewall, disk encryption, controlled folder access	
Detect		EDR sensor, Defender for Endpoint, antivirus telemetry	
Respond		Security tasks, investigation, isolation/remediation processes	
Enforce		Compliance, Conditional Access, device risk	
Govern		RBAC, scope tags, pilot rings, evidence, rollback	

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Architect control

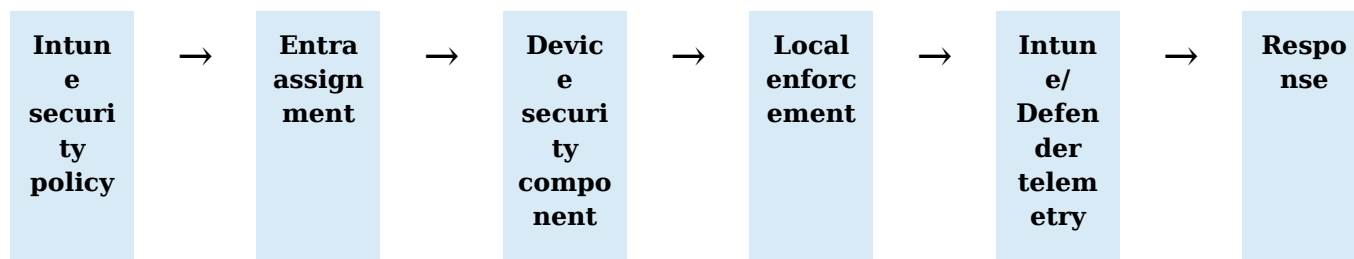
Do not deploy security settings blindly. Confirm licensing, platform support, dependencies, user impact, policy overlap, audit evidence, rollback, and incident ownership.

1. Endpoint Security Architecture

Endpoint security policies are purpose-built profiles grouped by security workload. They can coexist with configuration profiles and baselines, but all policy sources are equal configuration sources. Different values for the same setting can create conflicts.

Workload	Security objective	Typical evidence
Antivirus	Prevent and remediate malware	Agent health, signatures, detections, scan state
Firewall	Control network traffic	Profile state, rules, logs, check-in status
Disk encryption	Protect data at rest	Encryption status and recovery-key escrow
Account protection	Protect credentials and local privilege	Hello, Credential Guard, LAPS/EPM state
ASR	Reduce exploitable behaviors	Rule mode and event telemetry
EDR	Detect and respond to advanced threats	Onboarding and sensor health
App Control	Allow trusted code and block unapproved code	Policy state and code-integrity events
Security baselines	Apply recommended hardening bundle	Versioned profile and per-setting state

1.1 Architecture flow



1.2 Policy-source hierarchy

No automatic priority exists merely because a setting comes from Endpoint security. Establish one authoritative owner for each setting family and remove overlap.

2. Endpoint Security Overview Dashboard

Exact portal path

Microsoft Intune admin center > Endpoint security > Overview

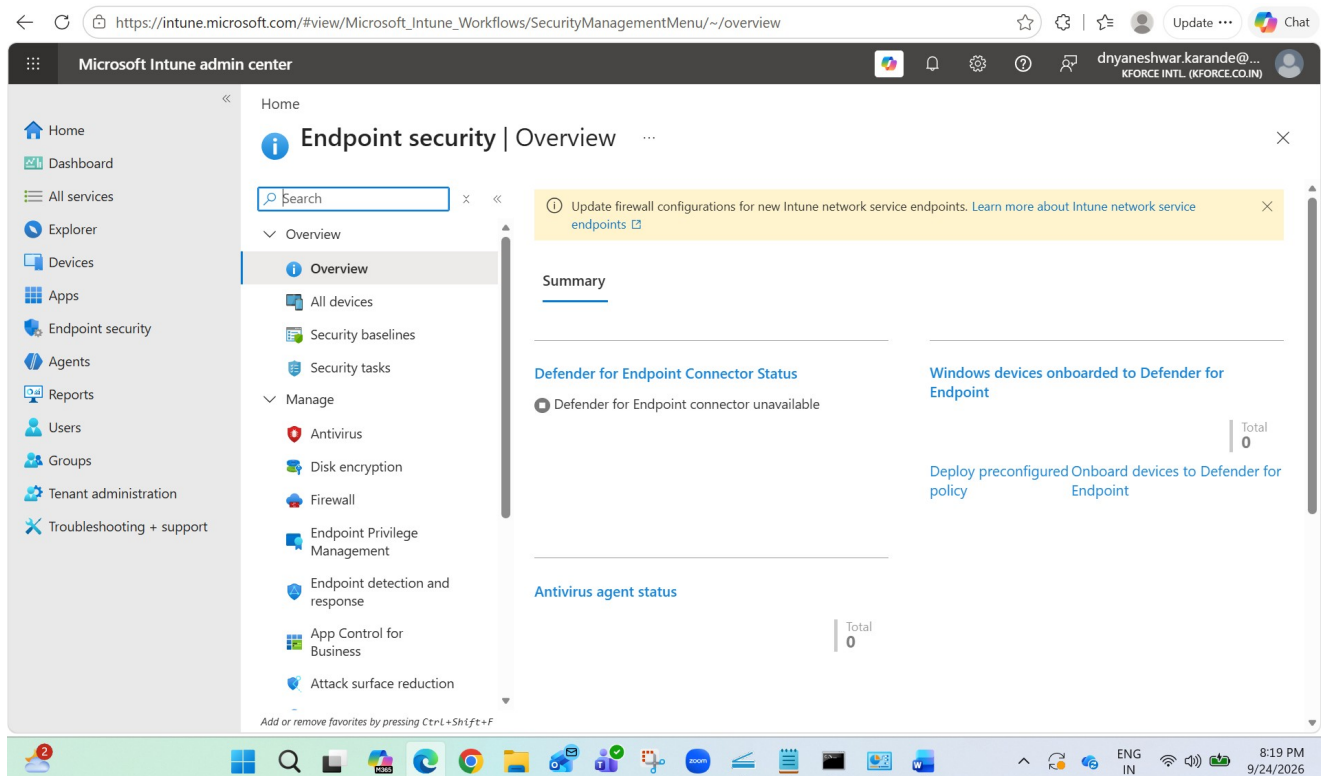


Figure 1. Endpoint security Overview displays connector status, Windows onboarding, antivirus agent status, navigation to security workloads, security baselines, tasks, and monitored controls.

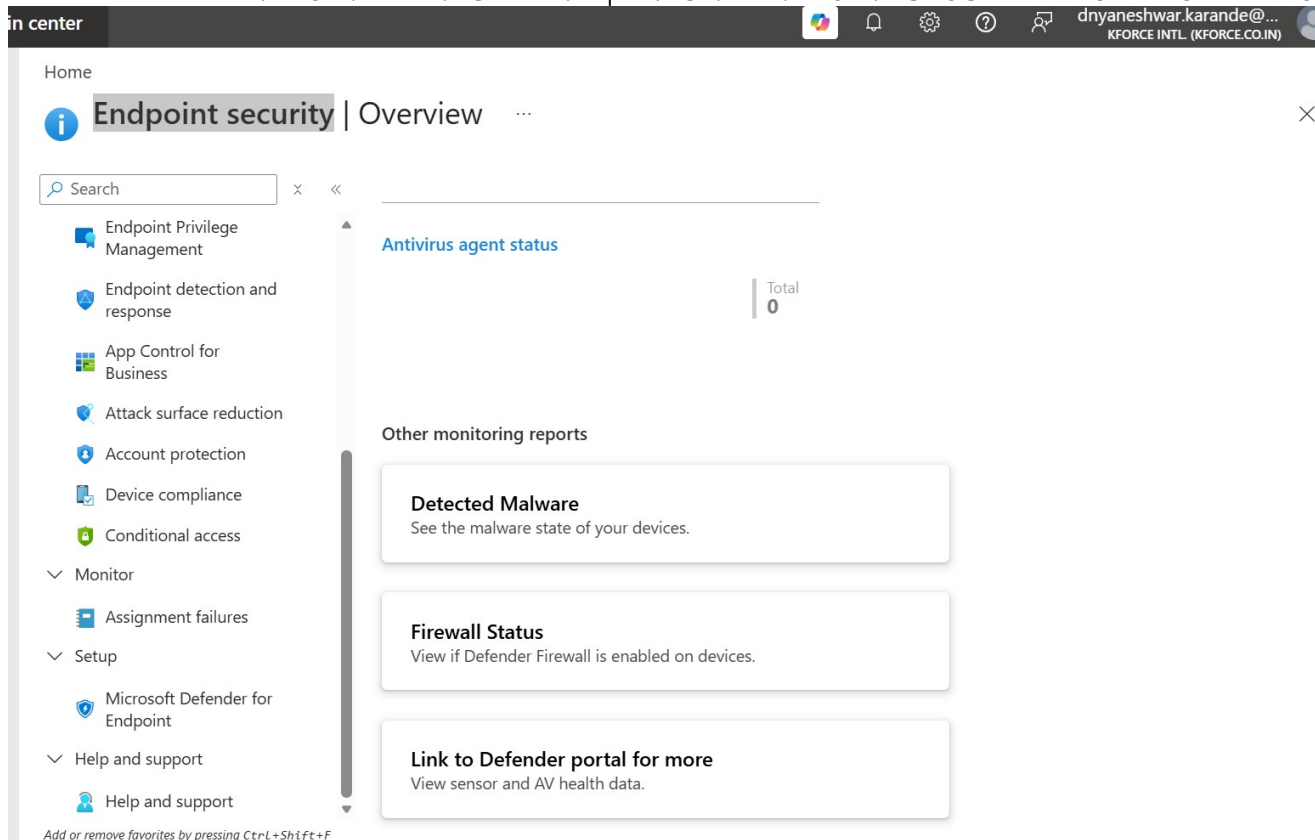


Figure 2. The lower Overview area exposes detected malware, firewall status, and a link to the Defender portal.

2.1 How to use the dashboard

- Review Defender for Endpoint connector status.
- Review onboarded-device visibility.
- Open antivirus or firewall reports for detail.
- Review security tasks and assignment failures.
- Do not use dashboard totals as the only acceptance evidence.

2.2 Real-world example

Scenario

The dashboard shows no active health data. The engineer validates connector status, policy assignment, device onboarding, licensing, and last check-in before assuming the environment is healthy or empty.

3. Microsoft Defender Antivirus Architecture

Exact portal path

Microsoft Intune admin center > Endpoint security > Antivirus

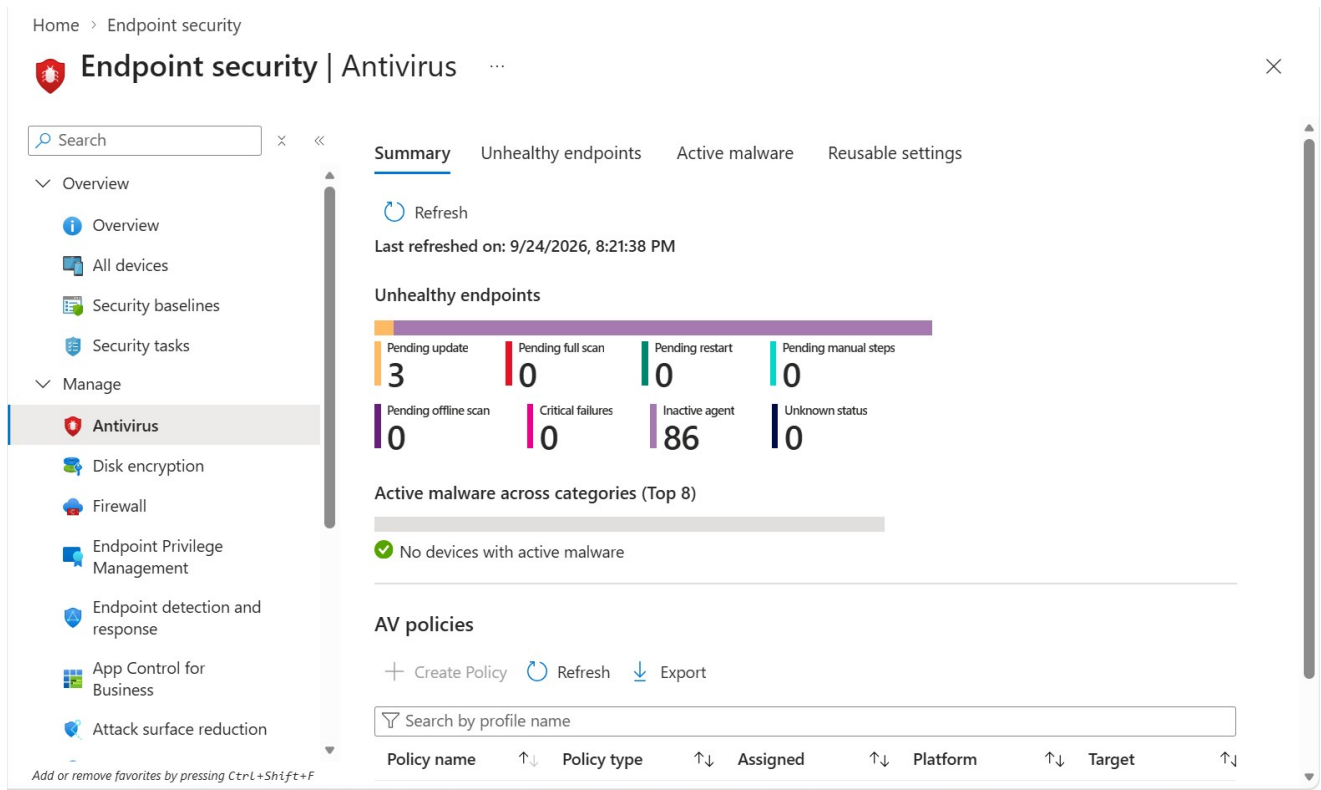


Figure 3. Antivirus Summary shows unhealthy endpoints, active malware, reusable settings, and antivirus policy inventory.

3.1 Create Antivirus policy

- Select Create Policy.
- Choose the supported platform.
- Select Microsoft Defender Antivirus profile.
- Enter name, description, scope tags, and settings.
- Assign to a pilot device group.
- Review and create.
- Monitor device and per-setting status.

3.2 Core control domains

Domain	Examples
Real-time protection	Behavior monitoring, downloaded file scanning, scripts
Cloud protection	Cloud-delivered protection and sample

Domain	Examples
	submission
Updates	Security intelligence update channel and cadence
Scans	Quick/full scan schedules and catch-up behavior
Exclusions	Approved process/path/file exclusions
Tamper protection	Protect security settings from unauthorized changes

4. Antivirus Health and Unhealthy Endpoints

Home > Endpoint security

Endpoint security | Antivirus

Search

Overview

- Overview
- All devices
- Security baselines
- Security tasks

Manage

- Antivirus**
- Disk encryption
- Firewall
- Endpoint Privilege Management
- Endpoint detection and response
- App Control for Business
- Attack surface reduction

Summary **Unhealthy endpoints** Active malware Reusable settings

Refresh Columns Export Restart Quick Scan Full Scan Sync

Search Device Signature update overdue : All Managed by: All

Showing 1 to 20 of 89 records

Select	Device name	Managed by	Malware protecti...	Signature update...
☐	APP-7TSNSN4ZAA4	Intune	Disabled	False
☐	APP8GB-4BV3KQNR	Intune	Enabled	True
☐	APP8GB-4JFNRF CG	Intune	Enabled	True
☐	APP8GB-APF5C69V	Intune	Disabled	False
☐	APP8GB-NN1AT8NS	Intune	Disabled	False
☐	IN-5CD5249872	Intune	Disabled	False
☐	IN-5CD524987D	Intune	Disabled	False
☐	IN-5CD52498H5	Intune	Disabled	False
☐	IN-5CD524B9V4	Intune	Disabled	False
☐	IN-5CD52933X7	Intune	Disabled	False

Add or remove favorites by pressing Ctrl+Shift+F

Figure 4. Antivirus Summary highlights pending updates, pending restart, pending full scan, recently scanned endpoints, and policy list.

Home > Endpoint security

Endpoint security | Antivirus

Summary **Unhealthy endpoints** Active malware Reusable settings

Refresh Columns Export Restart Quick Scan Full Scan Sync Update signatures

Search Device Signature update overdue : All Managed by: All

Showing 1 to 20 of 89 records

Device name	Managed by	Malware protecti...	Signature update...	State	Real-time protect...	Product st
APP-7TSNSN4ZAA4	Intune	Disabled	False	Clean	Disabled	No iss
APP8GB-4BV3KQNR	Intune	Enabled	True	Clean	Enabled	No sta
APP8GB-4JFNRF CG	Intune	Enabled	True	Clean	Enabled	No sta
APP8GB-APF5C69V	Intune	Disabled	False	Clean	Disabled	No iss
APP8GB-NN1AT8NS	Intune	Disabled	False	Clean	Disabled	No iss
IN-5CD5249872	Intune	Disabled	False	Clean	Disabled	No iss
IN-5CD524987D	Intune	Disabled	False	Clean	Disabled	No iss
IN-5CD52498H5	Intune	Disabled	False	Clean	Disabled	No iss
IN-5CD524B9V4	Intune	Disabled	False	Clean	Disabled	No iss
IN-5CD52933X7	Intune	Disabled	False	Clean	Disabled	No iss
IN-5CD52933X8	Intune	Disabled	False	Clean	Disabled	No iss

Figure 5. Unhealthy endpoints report lists device, management authority, malware protection, and signature status.

Home > Endpoint security

Endpoint security | Antivirus

Summary **Unhealthy endpoints** Active malware Reusable settings

Refresh Columns Export Restart Quick Scan Full Scan Sync Update signatures

Search Device Signature update overdue : All Managed by: All

Showing 1 to 20 of 89 records

Product status	Tamper protection ↑↓	Virtual machine ↑↓	Network protecti... ↑↓	Device reboot re... ↑↓	Full scan required ↑↓	Full scan
✓ No issues	Disabled	False	Disabled	False	False	False
⚠ No status flags set	Disabled	True	Enabled	False	False	False
⚠ No status flags set	Disabled	True	Enabled	False	False	False
✓ No issues	Disabled	False	Disabled	False	False	False
✓ No issues	Disabled	False	Disabled	False	False	False
✓ No issues	Disabled	False	Disabled	False	False	False
✓ No issues	Disabled	False	Disabled	False	False	False
✓ No issues	Disabled	False	Disabled	False	False	False
✓ No issues	Disabled	False	Disabled	False	False	False
✓ No issues	Disabled	False	Disabled	False	False	False

Figure 6. Additional endpoint columns show real-time protection, state, product status, and scan requirements.

Home > Endpoint security

Endpoint security | Antivirus

Summary **Unhealthy endpoints** Active malware Reusable settings

Refresh Columns Export Restart Quick Scan Full Scan Sync Update signatures

Search Device Signature update overdue : All Managed by: All

Showing 1 to 20 of 89 records

cti... ↑↓	Device reboot re... ↑↓	Full scan required ↑↓	Full scan overdue ↑↓	Last check-in ↑↓	MDE Sense Runn... ↑↓	MDE Onboarding... ↑↓
False	False	False	2026-09-24T06:26:08	False	Not onboarded	
False	False	False	2026-05-01T15:34:59	False	Not onboarded	
False	False	False	2026-05-01T16:45:21	False	Not onboarded	
False	False	False	2026-09-24T13:37:12	False	Not onboarded	
False	False	False	2026-09-24T05:35:14	False	Not onboarded	
False	False	False	2026-09-24T09:11:46	False	Not onboarded	
False	False	False	2026-09-24T04:45:05	False	Not onboarded	
False	False	False	2026-09-24T09:27:36	False	Not onboarded	
False	False	False	2026-09-24T12:51:11	False	Not onboarded	
False	False	False	2026-09-24T13:04:54	False	Not onboarded	

Figure 7. Health report continuation includes last check-in and MDE onboarding attributes.

ENDPOINT MANAGEMENT | INTUNE ENDPOINT SECURITY ARCHITECT EDITION

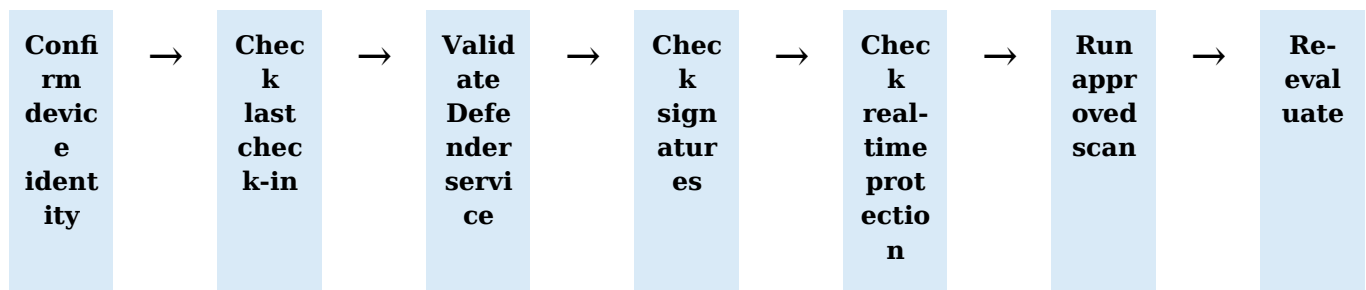
	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J
	DeviceName	ManagedBy	ManagedBy_loc	MalwareProtectionEnabled	SignatureUpdateOverdue	DeviceState	DeviceState_loc	RealTimeProtectionEnabled	ProductStatus	TamperProtectionEnabled
2	IN-5CG44513CN	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
3	IN-5CG5242YT4	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
4	IN-5CD52933XB	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
5	IN-5CG3025T0Z	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
6	IN-5CG5242YS3	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
7	IN-5CG52503N7	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
8	APP8GB-APF5C69V	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
9	IN-5CG5250343	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
10	IN-5CG54914CN	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
11	IN-5CD52933X7	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
12	IN-5CG44513CK	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
13	IN-5CD539GG44	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
14	IN-5CD5391HQ8	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
15	IN-5CD52933XP	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
16	IN-5CD539GGVG	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
17	IN-5CG44513CB	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
18	IN-5CD5390T7K	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
19	IN-5CD5390TFQ	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
20	IN-5CG5242YVM	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
21	IN-5CG44513CL	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
22	IN-5CD5390VF4	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
23	IN-5CG44513CF	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE
24	IN-5CG44513CJ	Intune	Intune	FALSE	FALSE	0 Clean		FALSE	0	FALSE

Figure 8. Exported unhealthy Defender agent report opened in Excel for analysis.

	A	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S
	DeviceName	TamperProtectionEnabled	IsVirtualMachine	NetworkInspectionSystemEnabled	RebootRequired	FullScanRequired	FullScanOverdue	LastReportedDate	IsWDATPSenseRunning	WDATPOnboardingStatus	
2	IN-5CG44513CN	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	01:08.0	FALSE	0	
3	IN-5CG5242YT4	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	43:12.8	FALSE	0	
4	IN-5CD52933XB	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	22:21.6	FALSE	0	
5	IN-5CG3025T0Z	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	34:00.7	FALSE	0	
6	IN-5CG5242YS3	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	29:48.1	FALSE	0	
7	IN-5CG52503N7	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	30:37.1	FALSE	0	
8	APP8GB-APF5C69V	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	37:12.9	FALSE	0	
9	IN-5CG5250343	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	19:06.2	FALSE	0	
10	IN-5CG54914CN	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	22:52.1	FALSE	0	
11	IN-5CD52933X7	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	04:54.7	FALSE	0	
12	IN-5CG44513CK	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	56:47.7	FALSE	0	
13	IN-5CD539GG44	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	19:42.5	FALSE	0	
14	IN-5CD5391HQ8	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	22:34.6	FALSE	0	
15	IN-5CD52933XP	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	57:35.3	FALSE	0	
16	IN-5CD539GGVG	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	35:29.7	FALSE	0	
17	IN-5CG44513CB	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	30:21.7	FALSE	0	
18	IN-5CD5390T7K	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	25:44.1	FALSE	0	
19	IN-5CD5390TFQ	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	17:45.5	FALSE	0	
20	IN-5CG5242YVM	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	27:51.0	FALSE	0	
21	IN-5CG44513CL	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	21:00.8	FALSE	0	
22	IN-5CD5390VF4	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	53:36.2	FALSE	0	
23	IN-5CG44513CF	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	18:17.3	FALSE	0	
24	IN-5CG44513CJ	0	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	14:55.3	FALSE	0	

Figure 9. Export continuation with protection, scan, signature, and version fields.

4.1 Investigation order



4.2 Real-world example

Scenario

A device shows signature update overdue and real-time protection disabled. The engineer confirms whether a third-party antivirus is authoritative, validates passive/active mode, updates security intelligence, restarts if required, and records the final health state.

5. Active Malware and Reusable Settings

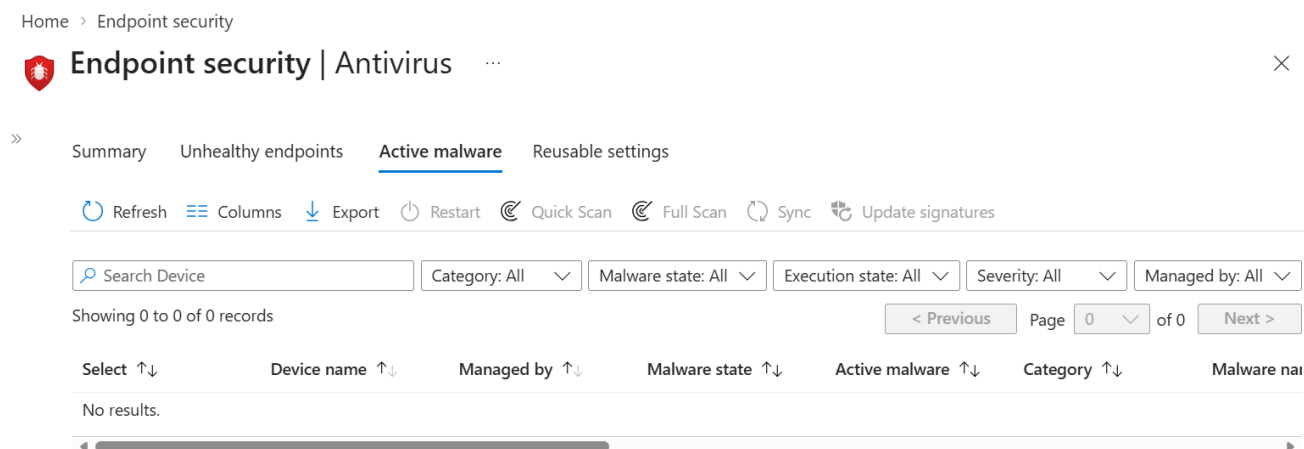


Figure 10. Active malware view with category, malware state, execution state, severity, and management filters.

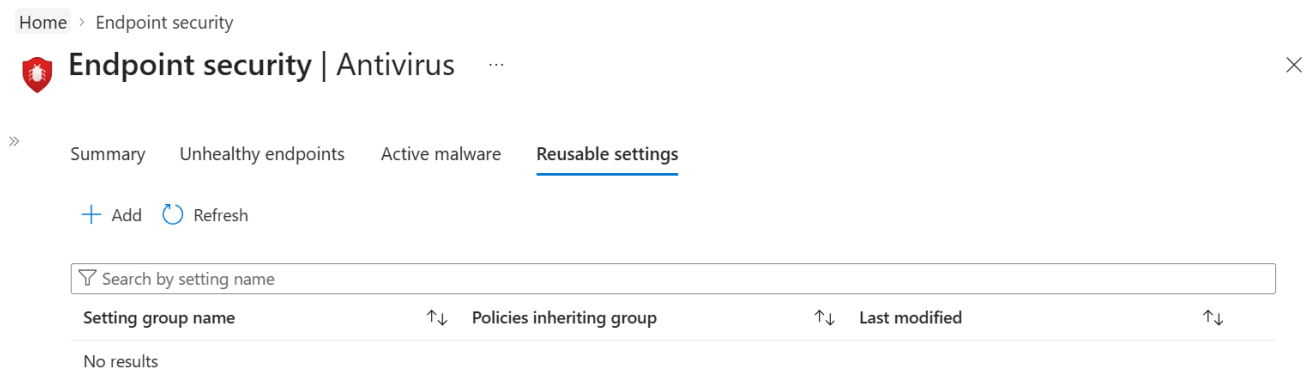


Figure 11. Reusable settings inventory for shared security configuration objects.

5.1 Malware response

- Confirm detection name, severity, device, user, and timestamp in Defender.
- Check remediation state and whether the device requires restart or scan.
- Follow the security incident process for isolation, evidence, and escalation.
- Do not delete evidence or suppress detections without security approval.

5.2 Reusable settings

Reusable settings reduce duplication for supported endpoint-security scenarios. Changes can affect every policy that references the shared object, so apply change control.

6. Microsoft Defender for Endpoint Connector

Exact portal path

Microsoft Intune admin center > Endpoint security > Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

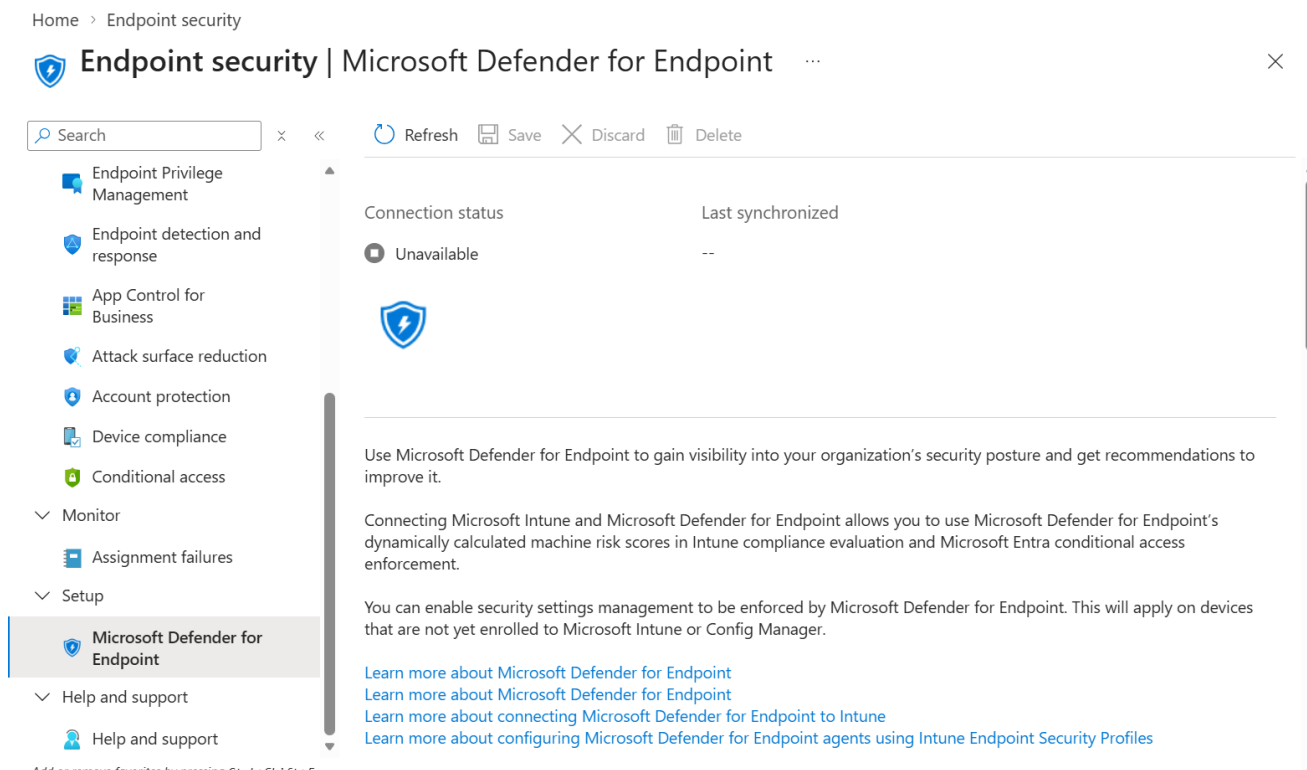


Figure 12. Defender for Endpoint connector overview with connection status and synchronization state.

Home > Endpoint security

Endpoint security | Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Search

Refresh Save Discard Delete

Configuring Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

1. Setup a connection to Intune via the Microsoft Defender Security Center: [Connect Microsoft Defender for Endpoint to Microsoft Intune in the Microsoft Defender Security Center](#)
2. After a connection is established, click "Refresh" at the top of this section to hide this guide and enable the settings below.
3. Configure the settings below.

Connector settings

Some toggles are disabled and acting as "off" because Microsoft Defender for Endpoint is not actively communicating with Intune for this account. Please check the state of the connection in the Microsoft Defender for Endpoint admin console.

When the connection has returned to a healthy status (Active or Provisioned), the toggles will be re-enabled and any pre-existing setting state will be restored.

Endpoint Security Profile Settings

Allow Microsoft Defender for Endpoint to enforce Endpoint Security Configurations

Compliance policy evaluation

Figure 13. Connector setup guidance and Endpoint Security Profile Settings toggle.

Home > Endpoint security

Endpoint security | Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Search

Refresh Save Discard Delete

Compliance policy evaluation

Connect Android devices version 6.0.0 and above to Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Connect iOS/iPadOS devices version 13.0 and above to Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Connect Windows devices version 10.0.15063 and above to Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Enable App Sync (sending application inventory) for iOS/iPadOS devices

Send full application inventory data on personally owned iOS/iPadOS devices

Block unsupported OS versions

App protection policy evaluation

Connect Android devices to Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Connect iOS/iPadOS devices to Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Mobile Threat Defense role

Grant MTD role permissions to Microsoft Defender for Endpoint on enrolled Android AM API personally owned with work profile, fully managed, and corporate owned with work profile devices

Figure 14. Compliance policy evaluation connector settings for Android and iOS/iPadOS.

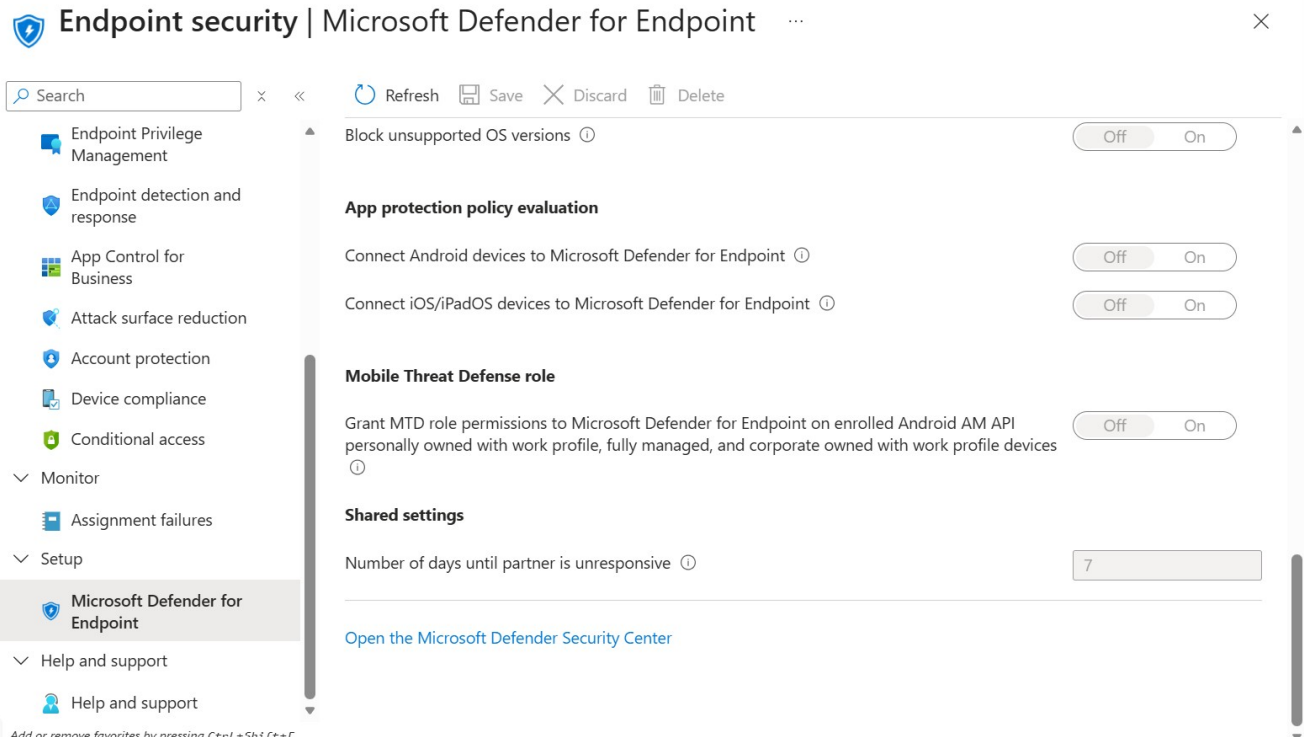
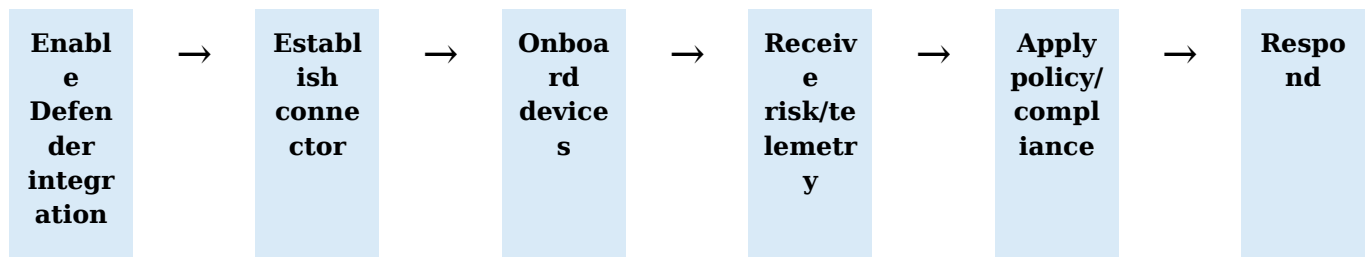


Figure 15. App protection, Mobile Threat Defense, unsupported OS, and shared connector settings.

6.1 Connector flow



6.2 Design notes

- Configure only settings supported by licensing and platform design.
- Understand the difference between Intune enrollment and Defender security settings management.
- Use machine risk in compliance only after the connector and device onboarding are validated.
- Test mobile platform connectors separately.

7. Windows Firewall Architecture

Exact portal path

Microsoft Intune admin center > Endpoint security > Firewall

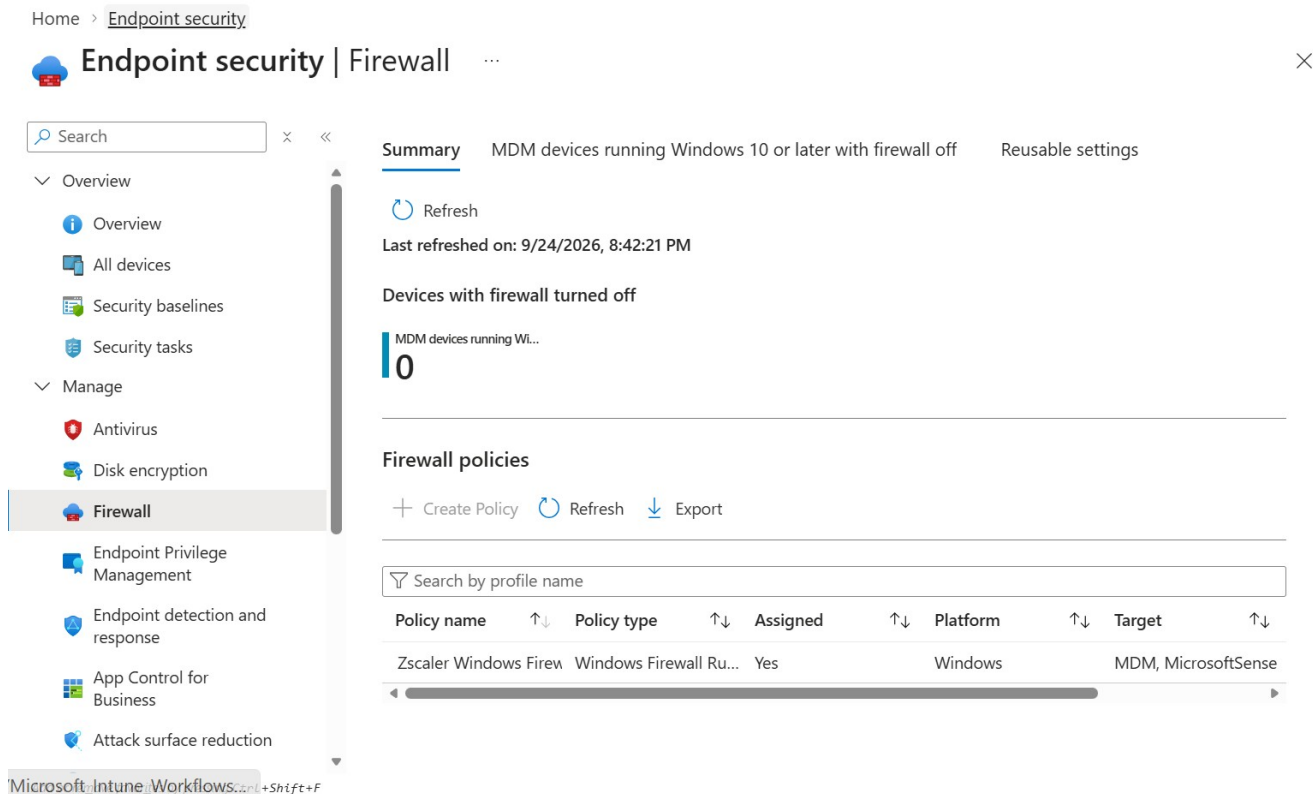


Figure 16. Firewall Summary with devices whose firewall is off and firewall policy inventory.

7.1 Policy layers

Layer	Purpose
Microsoft Defender Firewall profile	Configure domain/private/public profile behavior
Windows Firewall Rules	Create granular inbound/outbound rules
Reusable settings	Share endpoint groups where supported
Local policy merge	Controls whether local rules combine with managed rules

7.2 Create firewall policy

- Select Create Policy.
- Choose Windows platform and firewall profile.
- Configure profile state, default actions, notifications, logging, and merging according to standard.
- Assign to pilot devices.
- Validate each network profile and business application.

8. Zscaler Firewall Rule: Status and Assignment

Home > Endpoint security | Firewall



Zscaler Windows Firewall Rule

Windows Firewall Rules



Summarize with Copilot



Delete

Device and user check-in status



Device assignment status

This report shows all the devices that are targeted by the policy, including devices in a pending policy assignment state.

Per setting status

View the configuration status of each setting for this policy across all devices and users.

Properties

Figure 17. Zscaler Windows Firewall Rule check-in status shows successful assignments with no errors or conflicts.

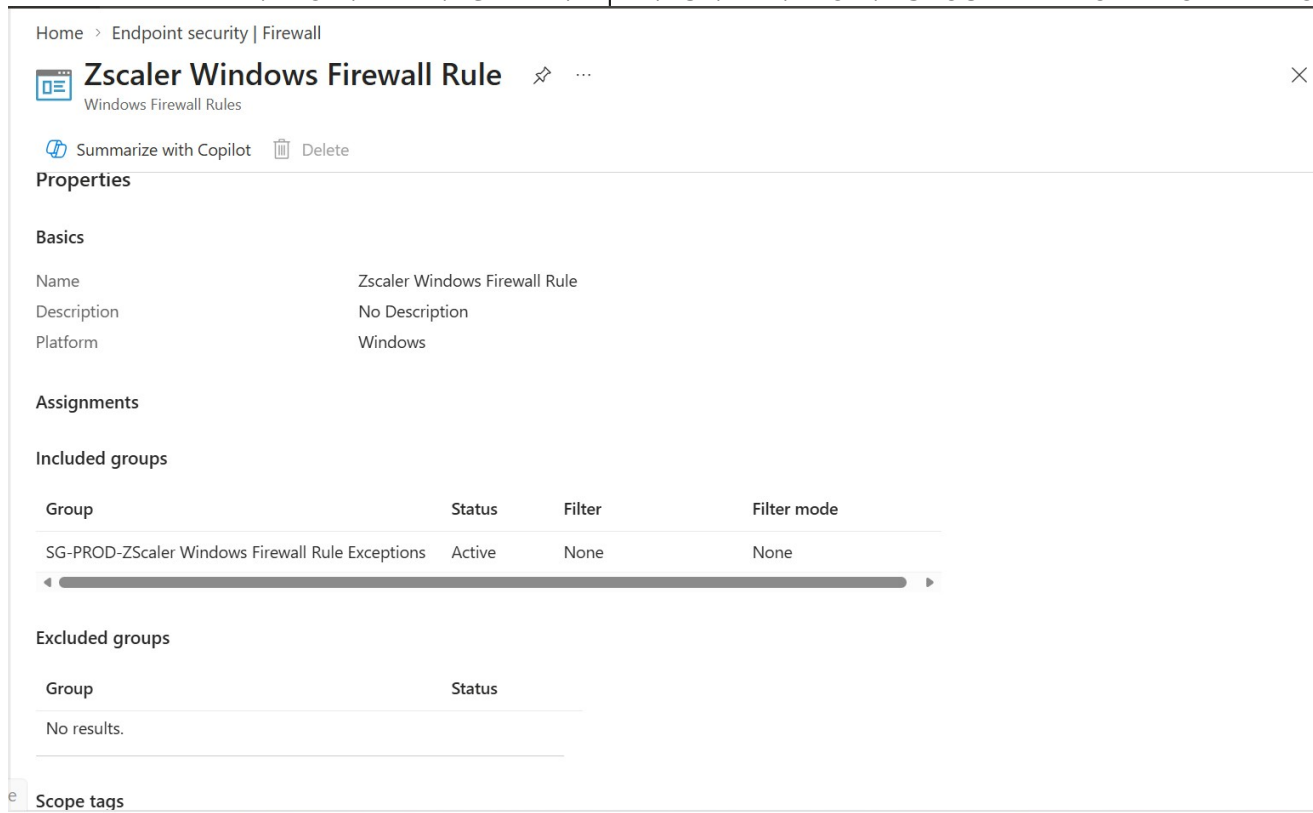


Figure 18. Policy properties show platform, included group, exclusions, scope tags, and assignments.

8.1 Interpretation

- Succeeded indicates policy processing, not complete application connectivity.
- Confirm the assigned pilot/production group is correct.
- Review exclusions and filters.
- Use per-setting status for failures.

8.2 Real-world example

Scenario

Zscaler service is installed but cannot establish a tunnel. The engineer confirms firewall policy assignment, program path, architecture, service status, destination ranges, ports, and local firewall logging.

9. Zscaler Firewall Rule: Ports, Protocols, and Programs

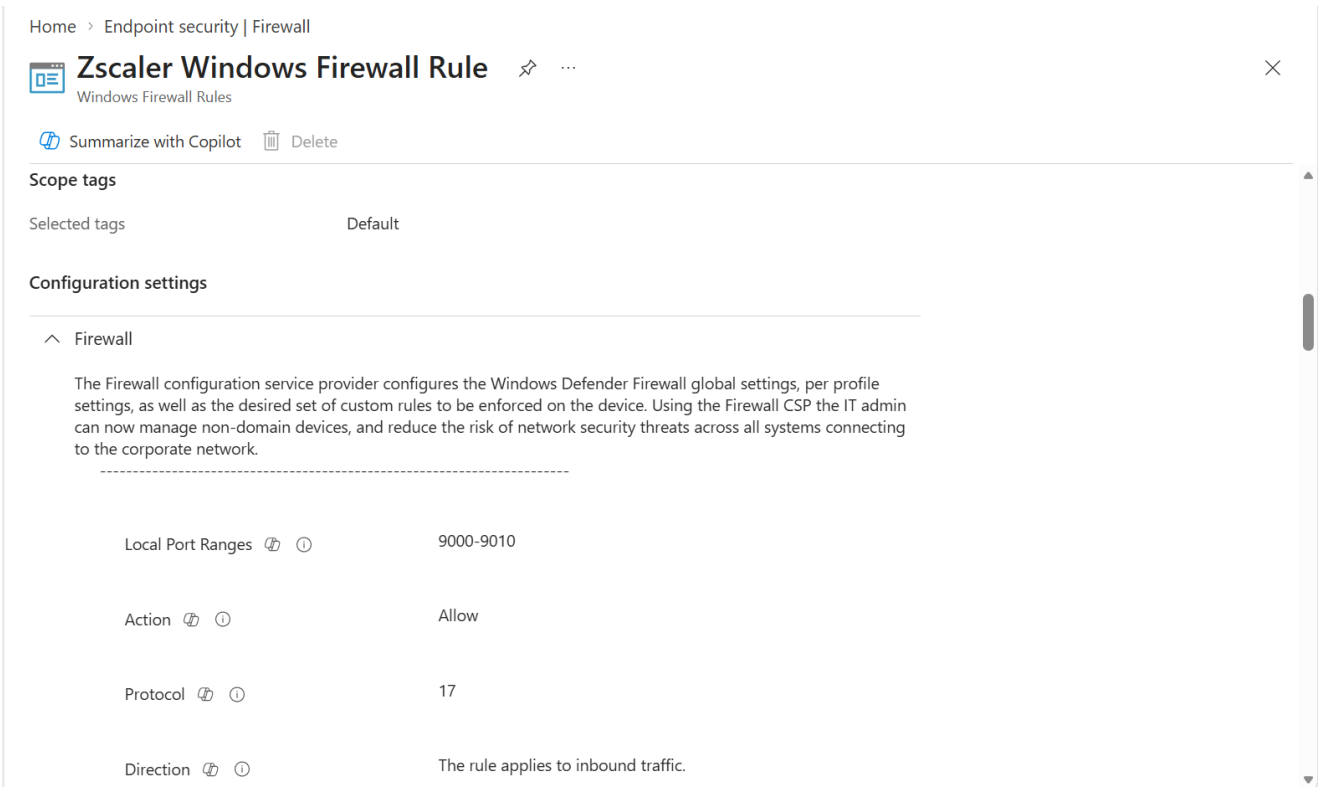


Figure 19. UDP rule configuration includes local port range, allow action, protocol 17, inbound direction, address range, and network profiles.

Home > Endpoint security | Firewall

 Zscaler Windows Firewall Rule

Windows Firewall Rules

 Summarize with Copilot  Delete

Direction  	The rule applies to inbound traffic.
Remote Address Ranges  	100.64.0.0/10
Enabled  	Enabled
Name  	Zscaler - UDP 9000-9010
Interface Types  	All
Network Types  	FW_PROFILE_TYPE_ALL: This value represents all these network sets and any future network sets.

Figure 20. UDP rule continuation with direction, remote address range, rule name, interfaces, and all network types.

Home > Endpoint security | Firewall

Zscaler Windows Firewall Rule

Windows Firewall Rules

Summarize with Copilot

Delete

Enabled

Name

Interface Types

Network Types

Local Port Ranges

Action

Protocol

Direction

Enabled

Zscaler - TCP 9000-9010

All

FW_PROFILE_TYPE_ALL: This value represents all these network sets and any future network sets.

9000-9010

Allow

6

The rule applies to inbound traffic

Figure 21. TCP rule uses protocol 6 and the approved port range.

Home > Endpoint security | Firewall



Zscaler Windows Firewall Rule

Windows Firewall Rules





 Summarize with Copilot

 Delete

Direction  	The rule applies to inbound traffic.
Remote Address Ranges  	100.64.0.0/10
Enabled  	Enabled
Name  	Zscaler – ZSATunnel – Outbound Allow (x86)
Interface Types  	All
File Path  	%ProgramFiles(x86)%\Zscaler\ZSATunnel\ZSATunnel.exe
Network Types  	FW_PROFILE_TYPE_ALL: This value represents all these network sets and any future network sets.

Figure 22. x86 ZSATunnel program rule shows file path and remote address scope.

Home > Endpoint security | Firewall

Zscaler Windows Firewall Rule

Windows Firewall Rules

Summarize with Copilot

Delete

Action

Allow

Direction

The rule applies to outbound traffic.

Enabled

Enabled

Name

Zscaler – ZSATunnel – Inbound Allow (x86)

Interface Types

All

File Path

%ProgramFiles(x86)%\Zscaler\ZSATunnel\ZSATunnel.exe

Network Types

FW_PROFILE_TYPE_ALL: This value represents all these network
categories and any future network categories.

Figure 23. A related x86 program rule shows outbound direction and executable path.

Home > Endpoint security | Firewall



Zscaler Windows Firewall Rule

Windows Firewall Rules

 Summarize with Copilot

 Delete

Network Types  

FW_PROFILE_TYPE_ALL: This value represents all these network sets and any future network sets.

Action  

Allow

Direction  

The rule applies to inbound traffic.

Enabled  

Enabled

Name  

Zscaler – ZSATunnel – Outbound Allow (x64)

Interface Types  

All

Figure 24. x64 ZSATunnel rule configuration for inbound traffic.

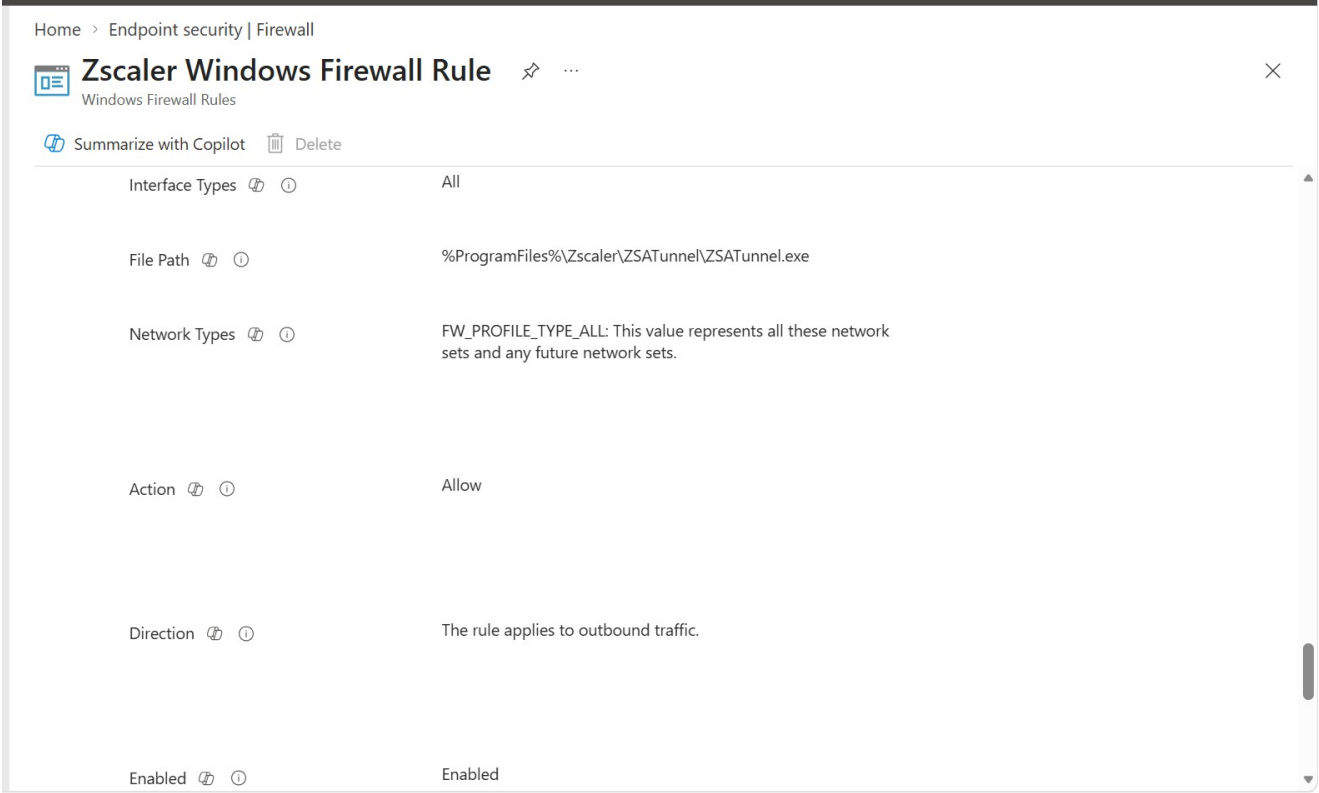


Figure 25. x64 program path and profile scope continuation.



Zscaler Windows Firewall Rule



Windows Firewall Rules



Summarize with Copilot



Delete

Enabled	Enabled
Name	Zscaler – ZSATunnel – Inbound Allow (x64)
Interface Types	All
File Path	%ProgramFiles%\Zscaler\ZSATunnel\ZSATunnel.exe
Network Types	FW_PROFILE_TYPE_ALL: This value represents all these network sets and any future network sets.
Action	Allow
Direction	The rule applies to inbound traffic.

Figure 26. Additional Zscaler firewall rule properties retained from the source tenant.

Home > Endpoint security | Firewall > Zscaler Windows Firewall Rule

Zscaler Windows Firewall Rule



Device configuration profile

Refresh Columns Export

Search by device name, U



Check-in status == all



Showing 1 to 6 of 6 records

< Previous Page 1 of 1 Next >

Device name ↑↓	Logged in user ↑↓	Check-in status ↑↓	Filter	Last report modification time ↑↓
IN-5CG3025T0Z	System account	Success		Tue Sep 01 2026 04:03:10 GMT+0530 (In...
IN-5CG3025T0Z	morty.smith@kforce.co.in	Success		Tue Sep 01 2026 16:54:49 GMT+0530 (In...
IN-5CG44513C6	romil.khowal@kforce.co.in	Success		Tue Sep 22 2026 14:41:47 GMT+0530 (In...
IN-5CG44513C6	System account	Success		Tue Sep 22 2026 14:37:58 GMT+0530 (In...
IN-5CG44513C8	System account	Success		Wed Sep 23 2026 10:02:07 GMT+0530 (In...
IN-5CG44513C8	abhishek.shivdekar@kforce.co.in	Success		Wed Sep 23 2026 15:26:33 GMT+0530 (In...

Figure 27. Firewall rule detail with action, direction, protocol, address, and program constraints.

IN-5CG3025T0Z - Policy Settings

This report may be delayed in showing the most recent information.

Refresh

Columns

0 items

Search

Add filters

Name	Status	Error code
------	--------	------------

Figure 28. Firewall policy continuation retained for rule-level review.

10. Firewall Rule Design Principles

Field	Architect question
Direction	Is the flow inbound or outbound?
Action	Allow or block, and why?
Protocol	TCP 6, UDP 17, or documented requirement?
Local/remote ports	Are ranges minimal and vendor-documented?
Local/remote addresses	Can scope be narrowed?
Program path	Does x86/x64 path match installation?
Profiles	Domain, private, public, or all?
Interface types	LAN, wireless, remote access, or all?

10.1 Rule validation

```
Get-NetFirewallRule -PolicyStore ActiveStore
Get-NetFirewallPortFilter
Get-NetFirewallApplicationFilter
```

Least exposure

Create the narrowest rule that permits the required business flow. Avoid broad Any/All rules unless the vendor requirement and security approval explicitly support them.

11. Disk Encryption Architecture

Exact portal path

Microsoft Intune admin center > Endpoint security > Disk encryption

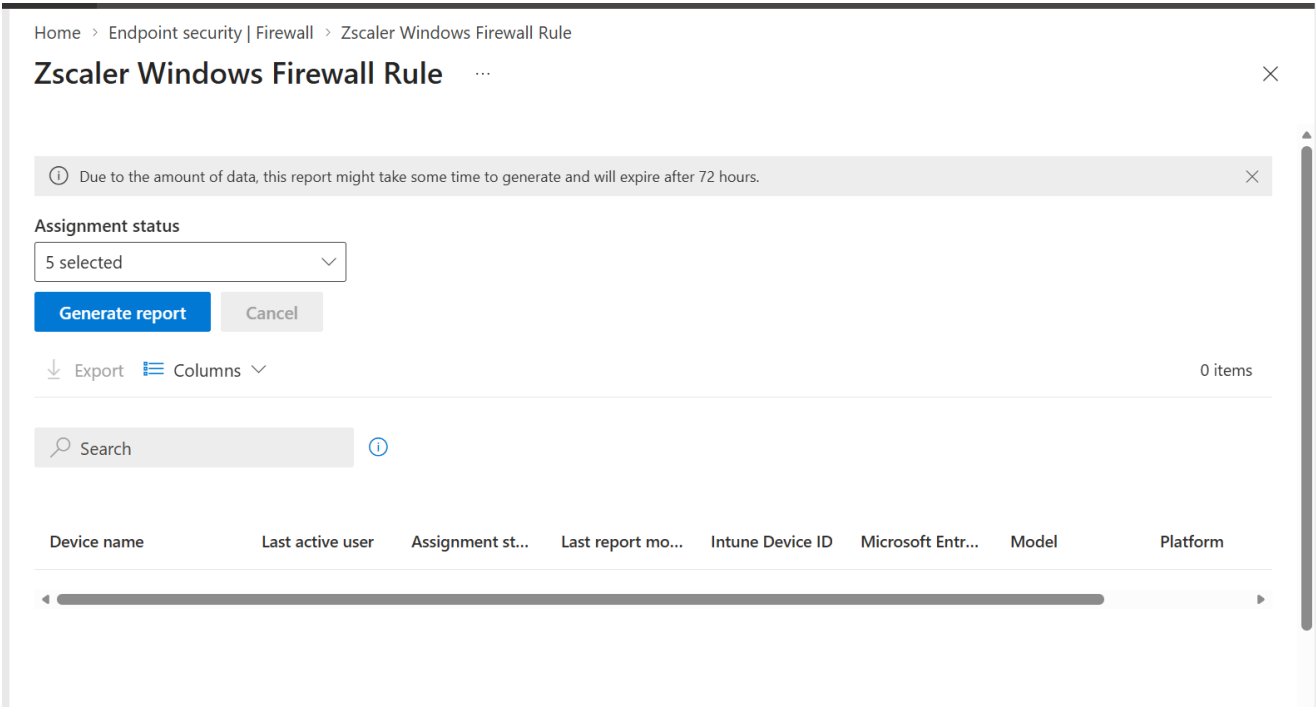


Figure 29. Disk encryption policy area and encrypted-device monitoring.

Home > Endpoint security



Endpoint security | Firewall



Search

Overview

Overview

All devices

Security baselines

Security tasks

Manage

Antivirus

Disk encryption

Firewall

Summary

MDM devices running Windows 10 or later with firewall off

Reusable settings



Refresh



Columns



Export



Restart



Sync

Search Device name, User principal name

Showing 0 to 0 of 0 records

< Previous

Page

0

of 0

Next >

Select ↑↓

Device name ↑↓

Firewall status ↑↓

User Principal Na... ↑↓

Target ↑↓

No results.

Figure 30. Disk encryption policy properties and assignment reference.

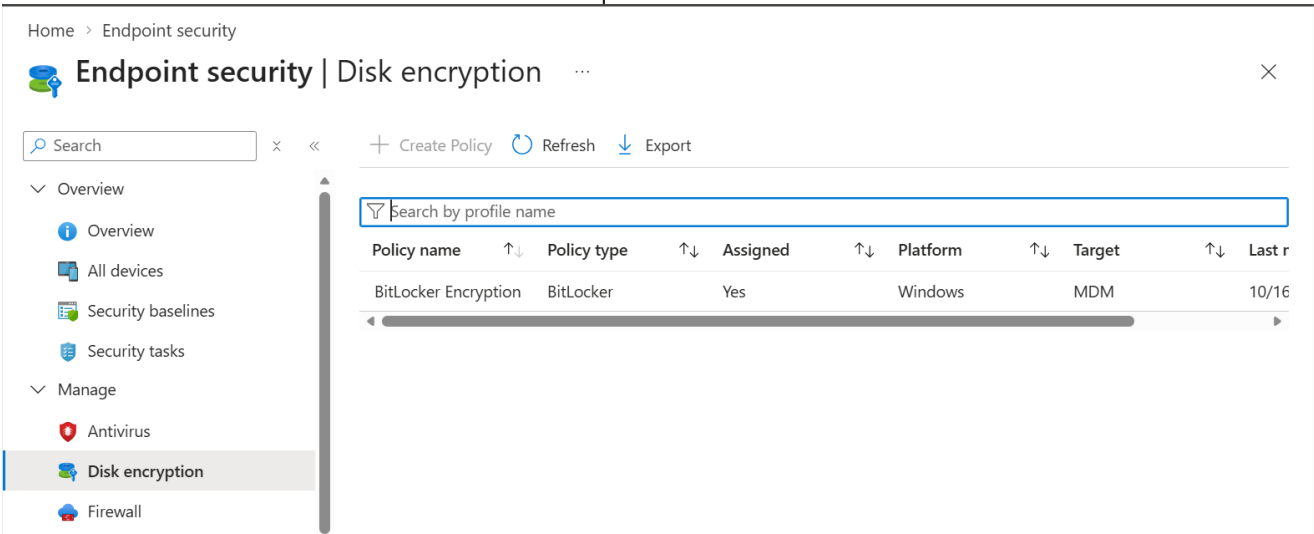


Figure 31. BitLocker/FileVault configuration settings reference.

 BitLocker Encryption

BitLocker

 Summarize with Copilot  Delete

Device and user check-in status



Device assignment status

This report shows all the devices that are targeted by the policy, including devices in a pending policy assignment state.

Per setting status

View the configuration status of each setting for this policy across all devices and users.

Properties

Figure 32. Disk encryption device status and reporting reference.

 BitLocker Encryption

BitLocker

 Summarize with Copilot

 Delete

Properties

Basics

Name	BitLocker Encryption
Description	No Description
Platform	Windows

Assignments

Included groups

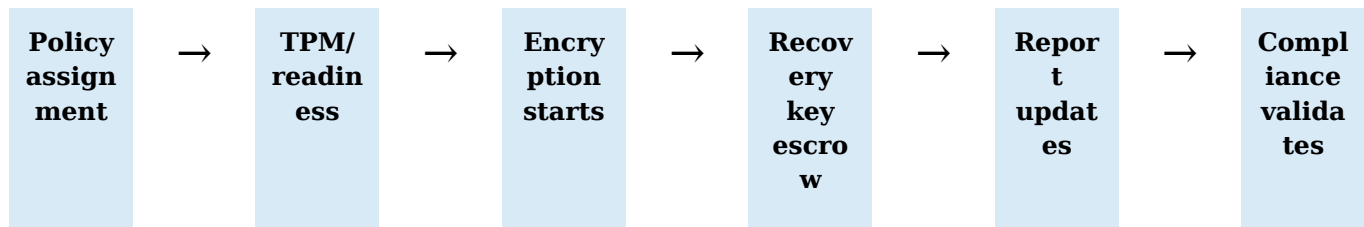
Group	Status	Filter	Filter mode
SG-PROD-INDIA-IDC-Windows Devices	Active	None	None

Excluded groups

Group	Status
No results.	

Figure 33. Recovery and encryption configuration continuation.

11.1 Encryption flow



11.2 Windows design

- Choose encryption method and strength according to security standard.
- Configure silent enablement requirements.
- Escrow recovery information before high-impact enforcement where required.
- Control removable-drive behavior.
- Validate TPM, Secure Boot, Windows edition, and recovery process.

11.3 Real-world example

Scenario

A device is managed but remains unencrypted. The engineer reviews BitLocker profile status, TPM readiness, conflicting policy, reboot requirements, local manage-bde output, and recovery-key escrow.

12. Account Protection Architecture

Exact portal path

Microsoft Intune admin center > Endpoint security > Account protection

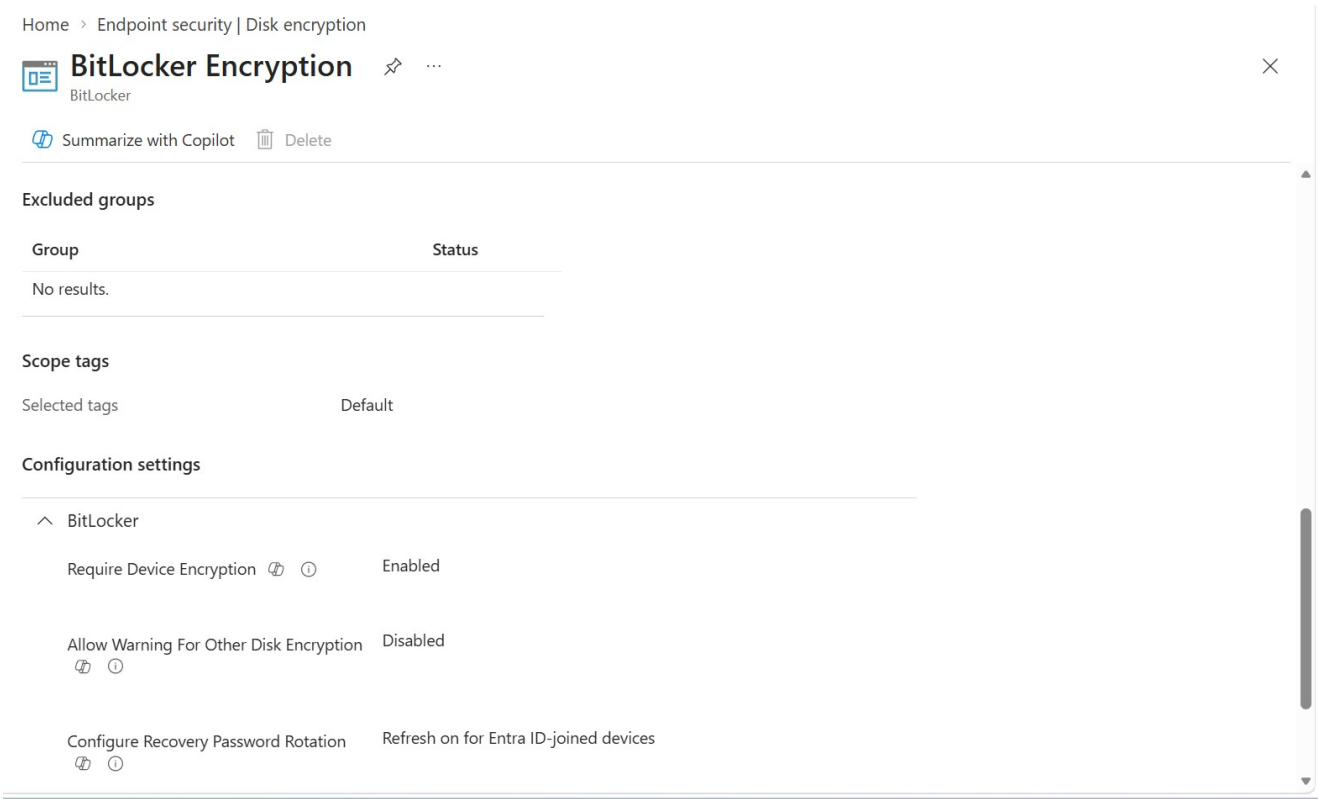


Figure 34. Account protection policy workspace.

Home > Endpoint security | Disk encryption

 BitLocker Encryption

BitLocker

 Summarize with Copilot

 Delete

Configure Recovery Password Rotation  

Refresh on for Entra ID-joined devices

Allow Standard User Encryption  

Enabled

^ Administrative Templates

BitLocker Drive Encryption

Choose drive encryption method and cipher strength (Windows 10 [Version 1511] and later)  

Enabled

BitLocker Drive Encryption > Operating System Drives

Enforce drive encryption type on operating system drives  

Enabled

Figure 35. Account protection properties and assignment reference.

Home > Endpoint security | Disk encryption

 BitLocker Encryption

BitLocker

 Summarize with Copilot  Delete

Require additional authentication at startup  

Enabled

Enable use of BitLocker authentication requiring preboot keyboard input on slates  

Enabled

Choose how BitLocker-protected operating system drives can be recovered  

Enabled

BitLocker Drive Encryption > Fixed Data Drives

Enforce drive encryption type on fixed data drives  

Enabled

Figure 36. Windows Hello or credential-protection settings reference.

 BitLocker Encryption

BitLocker

 Summarize with Copilot  Delete

Choose how BitLocker-protected fixed drives can be recovered   Enabled

Deny write access to fixed drives not protected by BitLocker   Disabled

BitLocker Drive Encryption > Removable Data Drives

Select the encryption method for removable data drives:  AES-CBC 128-bit (default)

Select the encryption method for operating system drives:  XTS-AES 256-bit

Select the encryption method for fixed data drives:  XTS-AES 256-bit

Select the encryption type:  Full encryption

Figure 37. Local account or privilege-protection configuration reference.

 **BitLocker Encryption**  

BitLocker

 Summarize with Copilot  Delete

Select the encryption type: 	Full encryption
Configure TPM startup key: 	Do not allow startup key with TPM
Configure TPM startup key and PIN: 	Do not allow startup key and PIN with TPM
Allow BitLocker without a compatible TPM (requires a password or a startup key on a USB flash drive) 	False
Configure TPM startup: 	Require TPM
Configure TPM startup PIN: 	Do not allow startup PIN with TPM
Omit recovery options from the BitLocker setup wizard 	True
OSRecoveryKeyUsageDropDown_Name	Allow 256-bit recovery key

Figure 38. Account protection policy status reference.

12.1 Controls

Control	Purpose
Windows Hello for Business	Phishing-resistant user sign-in with device-bound credentials
Credential Guard	Protect derived credentials using virtualization-based security
Local users/groups	Control local group membership
Windows LAPS	Rotate and securely store local administrator passwords
Endpoint Privilege Management	Allow standard users approved elevation workflows

12.2 Real-world example

Scenario

A support application requires elevation. Instead of making the user a permanent local administrator, security and endpoint teams create a controlled EPM elevation rule with publisher/file evidence and audit monitoring.

13. Attack Surface Reduction Architecture

Exact portal path

Microsoft Intune admin center > Endpoint security > Attack surface reduction

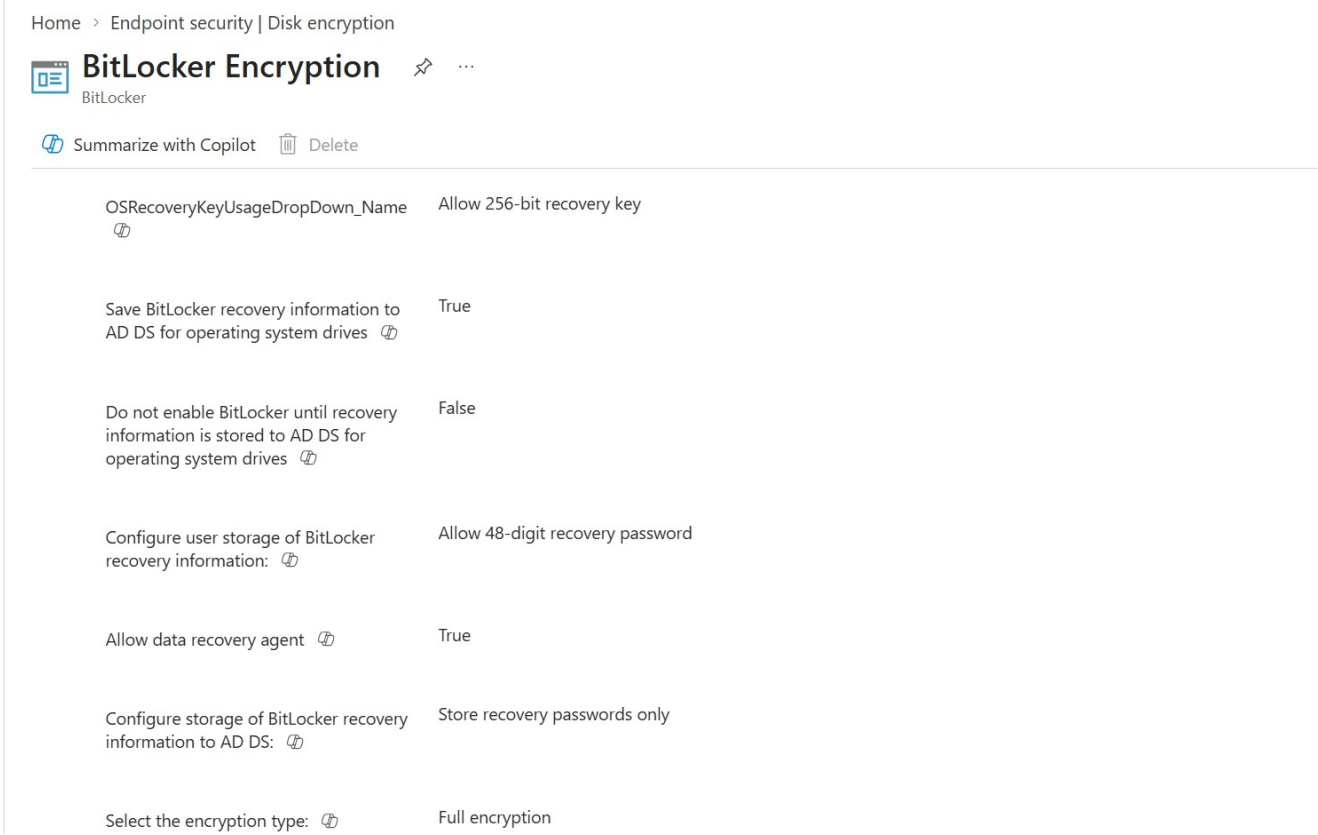


Figure 39. ASR policy workspace.

 BitLocker Encryption

BitLocker



 Summarize with Copilot  Delete

Select the encryption type: 	Full encryption
Do not enable BitLocker until recovery information is stored to AD DS for fixed data drives 	True
Allow data recovery agent 	True
Configure storage of BitLocker recovery information to AD DS: 	Backup recovery passwords and key packages
FDVRecoveryKeyUsageDropDown_Name 	Allow 256-bit recovery key
Omit recovery options from the BitLocker setup wizard 	False
Save BitLocker recovery information to AD DS for fixed data drives 	True

Figure 40. ASR policy/profile reference.

 BitLocker Encryption

BitLocker

 Summarize with Copilot  Delete

Allow data recovery agent 	True
Configure storage of BitLocker recovery information to AD DS: 	Backup recovery passwords and key packages
FDVRecoveryKeyUsageDropDown_Name 	Allow 256-bit recovery key
Omit recovery options from the BitLocker setup wizard 	False
Save BitLocker recovery information to AD DS for fixed data drives 	True
Configure user storage of BitLocker recovery information: 	Allow 48-digit recovery password

Figure 41. ASR rule configuration reference.

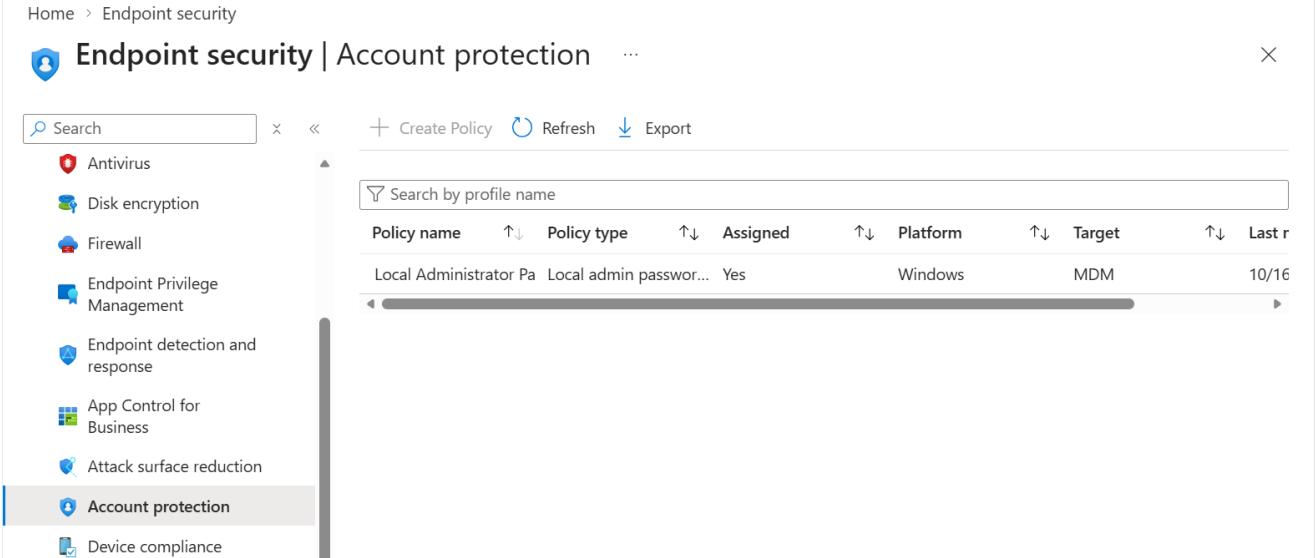


Figure 42. ASR rule modes and settings reference.

Home > Endpoint security | Account protection



Local Administrator Password Solution



Local admin password solution (Windows LAPS)



Summarize with Copilot



Delete

Device and user check-in status



View report

Device assignment status

This report shows all the devices that are targeted by the policy, including devices in a pending policy assignment state.

Per setting status

View the configuration status of each setting for this policy across all devices and users.

Properties

Figure 43. Device control or exploit-protection reference.

 Local Administrator Password Solution

Local admin password solution (Windows LAPS)

 Summarize with Copilot  Delete

Properties

Basics

Name	Local Administrator Password Solution
Description	Creates local admin account and managed password
Platform	Windows

Assignments

Included groups

Group	Status	Filter	Filter mode
SG-PROD-INDIA-IDC-Windows Devices	Active	None	None
SG-PROD-KIOSK-Glider Devices	Active	None	None



Excluded groups

Group	Status
No results.	

Figure 44. Web protection or network protection reference.

 Local Administrator Password Solution

Local admin password solution (Windows LAPS)

 Summarize with Copilot  Delete

Group	Status
No results.	

Scope tags

Selected tags	Default
---------------	---------

Configuration settings

^ LAPS		
Backup Directory	 	Backup the password to Microsoft Entra ID only
Password Complexity	 	Large letters + small letters + numbers + special characters (improved readability)
Password Length	 	15
Post Authentication Actions	 	Reset the password and logoff the managed account: upon expiry of the password, the managed account password will be reset and the user will be required to log off and log back on.

Figure 45. Controlled folder access reference.

 Local Administrator Password Solution

Local admin password solution (Windows LAPS)

 Summarize with Copilot

 Delete

Post Authentication Actions  	Reset the password and logoff the managed account: upon expiry of the grace period, the managed account password will be reset and any interactive logon sessions using the managed account will terminated.
Post Authentication Reset Delay   4	
Automatic Account Management Enabled  	The target account will be automatically managed
Password Age Days   30	
Automatic Account Management Randomize Name  	The name of the target account will use a random numeric suffix.
Automatic Account Management Name Or Prefix  	Gatekeeper
Automatic Account Management Target  	Manage a new custom administrator account

Figure 46. Device control configuration reference.

Local Administrator Password Solution ...

Local admin password solution (Windows LAPS)

 Summarize with Copilot  Delete

Automatic Account Management Enabled  ⓘ	The target account will be automatically managed
Password Age Days  ⓘ	30
Automatic Account Management Randomize Name  ⓘ	The name of the target account will use a random numeric suffix.
Automatic Account Management Name Or Prefix  ⓘ	Gatekeeper
Automatic Account Management Target  ⓘ ⓘ	Manage a new custom administrator account
Automatic Account Management Enable Account  ⓘ ⓘ	The target account will be enabled

Figure 47. ASR assignment/status reference.

Local Administrator Password Solution



Device configuration profile

Refresh Columns Export

Search by device name, ...

Check-in status == all

Succeeded **194**
Error **0**
Conflict **0**
Not applicable **0**
In Progress **0**

Showing 1 to 50 of 194 records

< Previous

Page

1 of 4

Next >

Device name ↑↓	Logged in user ↑↓	Check-in status ↑↓	Filter	Last report modification time ↑↓
IN-5CD5249872	System account	Success		Tue Aug 25 2026 09:54:16 GMT+0530 (India Sta...
IN-5CD5249872	manish.hiwase@kforce.co.in	Success		Wed Sep 23 2026 10:16:16 GMT+0530 (India St...
IN-5CD524987D	sonika.katariya@kforce.co.in	Success		Wed Sep 23 2026 10:40:39 GMT+0530 (India St...
IN-5CD524987D	System account	Success		Thu Sep 17 2026 09:35:36 GMT+0530 (India Sta...
IN-5CD524987L	System account	Success		Tue Sep 22 2026 10:26:10 GMT+0530 (India Sta...
IN-5CD524987L	sakshi.sharma@kforce.co.in	Success		Wed Sep 23 2026 22:06:07 GMT+0530 (India St...
IN-5CD52498H5	procheta.ganguly@kforce.co.in	Success		Tue Sep 22 2026 15:27:09 GMT+0530 (India Sta...
IN-5CD52498H5	System account	Success		Tue Sep 15 2026 09:57:58 GMT+0530 (India Sta...

Figure 48. ASR policy continuation.

Local Administrator Password Solution

...

×

ⓘ Due to the amount of data, this report might take some time to generate and will expire after 72 hours.

×

Assignment status

5 selected

Generate report

Cancel

↓ Export

☰ Columns

0 items

🔍 Search

ⓘ

Device name	Last active user	Assignment st...	Last report mo...	Intune Device ID	Microsoft Entr...	Model	Platform
-------------	------------------	------------------	-------------------	------------------	-------------------	-------	----------

Figure 49. ASR monitoring/reference view.

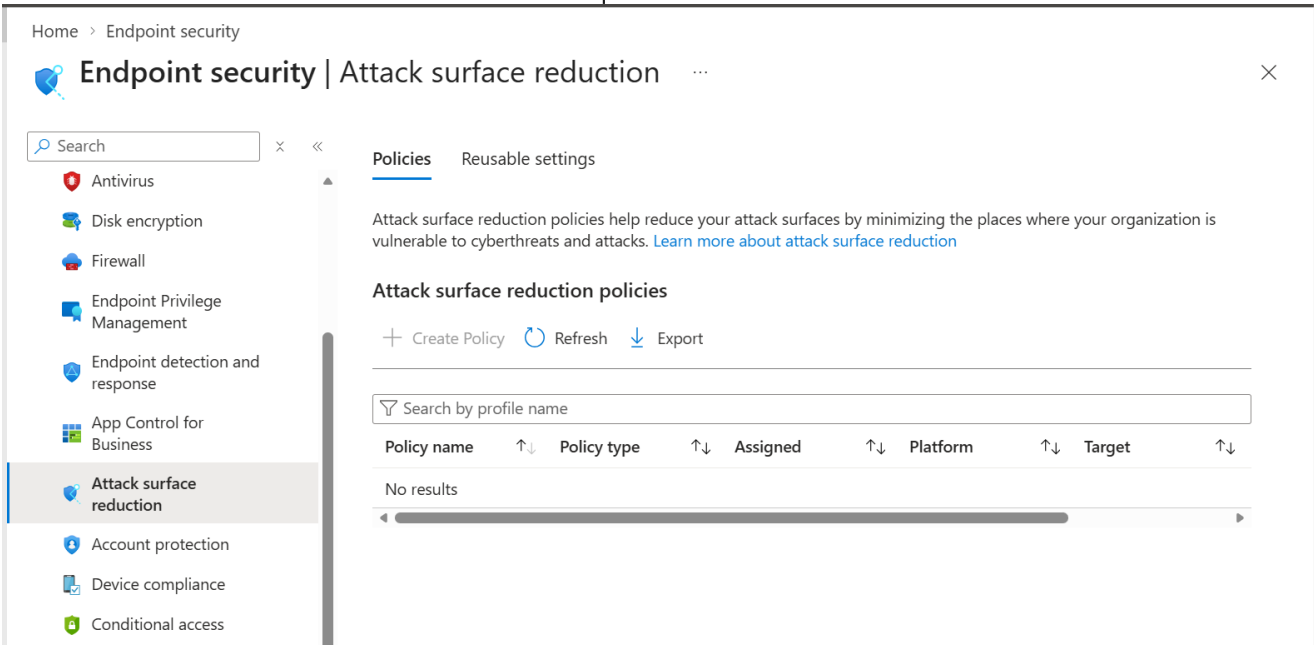


Figure 50. Attack surface reduction Policies and Reusable settings tabs.

Endpoint security | Attack surface reduction

Search

Antivirus

Disk encryption

Firewall

Endpoint Privilege Management

Endpoint detection and response

App Control for Business

Attack surface reduction

Account protection

Device compliance

Policies Reusable settings

Create setting groups containing a reusable list of one or more endpoints to protect. Device control policies created in the 'Policies' tab can refer to this setting group. Each device control policy can allow or block access to all specified endpoints. Changes made to these settings automatically apply to policies that refer to them. Note: Devices defined here must be onboarded to Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE). [Learn more about reusable setting groups](#)

+ Add ↺ Refresh

Search by setting name

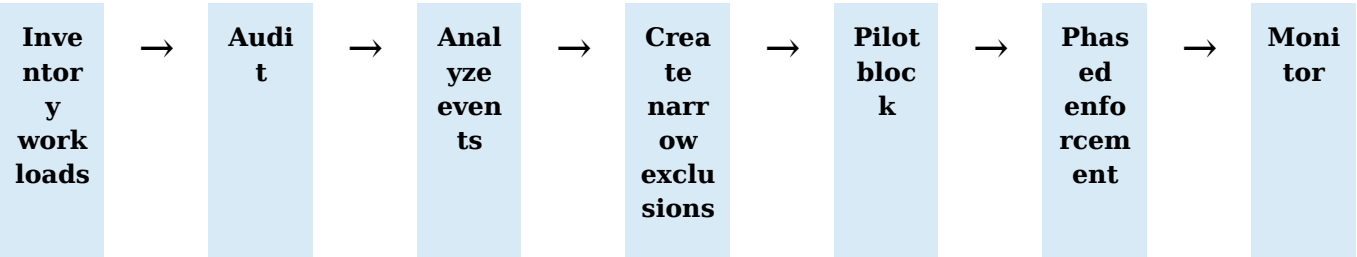
Setting group name	↑↓	Policies inheriting group	↑↓	Last modified	↑↓
No results					

Figure 51. Reusable setting groups for endpoints used by device-control policies.

13.1 Deployment modes

Mode	Use
Audit	Collect impact evidence without blocking
Warn	Prompt user where supported and collect telemetry
Block	Enforce after exclusions and business validation
Disabled/Not configured	No enforcement from that policy

13.2 Safe rollout



13.3 Real-world example

Scenario

An ASR rule in Audit identifies a finance macro workflow. Security validates the signed application and business process, creates the narrowest approved exclusion, retests, and only then enables Block for the pilot ring.

14. Endpoint Detection and Response

Exact portal path

Microsoft Intune admin center > Endpoint security > Endpoint detection and response

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Intune admin center interface. The breadcrumb path is 'Home > Endpoint security'. The main heading is 'Endpoint security | Endpoint detection and response'. The left sidebar contains a search bar and a list of navigation items: Endpoint Privilege Management, Endpoint detection and response (selected), App Control for Business, Attack surface reduction, Account protection, Device compliance, Conditional access, Monitor, Assignment failures, Setup, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, and Help and support.

The main content area has two tabs: 'Summary' (selected) and 'EDR Onboarding Status'. Under the 'Summary' tab, there is a section titled 'Defender for Endpoint Connector Status' with a status indicator showing 'Defender for Endpoint connector unavailable'. Below this is a section titled 'Windows devices onboarded to Defender for Endpoint' with a progress bar showing '0 / 0'. A table below the progress bar shows the onboarding status of devices:

Onboarded	Not Onboarded	Total
0	0	0

At the bottom of the main content area, there is a section titled 'Endpoint detection and response (EDR) policies' with buttons for '+ Create policy', 'Refresh', 'Export', and 'Columns'.

Figure 52. EDR Summary shows connector status and onboarding visibility.

Home > Endpoint security

Endpoint security | Endpoint detection and response

Search

- Endpoint Privilege Management
- Endpoint detection and response**
- App Control for Business
- Attack surface reduction
- Account protection
- Device compliance
- Conditional access
- Monitor
 - Assignment failures
- Setup
 - Microsoft Defender for Endpoint
- Help and support
 - Help and support

Summary **EDR Onboarding Status**

Create an Endpoint detection and response policy to onboard devices to Microsoft Defender for Endpoint. Other options can be found in the [Defender Portal](#). For devices that are on premises, [learn more about deploying Defender for Endpoint](#).

Refresh Export Columns Deploy preconfigured policy

Search Add filters

0 / 0

Onboarded	Not Onboarded	Total
0	0	0

Device name	Managed by	Defender sensor state	Onboardi

Figure 53. EDR Onboarding Status and policy creation guidance.

https://security.microsoft.com/homepage?tid=dd72a2d2-8ec1-4f74-9b3a-e66f079e7fd4

Microsoft Defender

Home

Get your SIEM and XDR in one place

Work faster with less complexity. Run SIEM and XDR from one portal to investigate threats faster, automate response, and avoid tool switching with built-in AI, unified search, and threat intelligence.

Connect a workspace

Guided tour What's new? Community Add cards

Microsoft Secure Score

Secure Score: 55.42%

151.31/273 points achieved

Microsoft Secure Score is a representation of your

Action center

No actions pending approval

Last 30 days

Threat analytics

0 threats require action

Active Alerts Resolved Alerts No Alerts

12:45 AM 9/25/2026

Figure 54. Microsoft Defender portal home, the investigation and response destination for incidents and alerts.

14.1 EDR flow





14.2 Create EDR policy

- Select Create Policy.
- Choose supported platform and Endpoint detection and response profile.
- Configure onboarding package/connector-based settings shown by the portal.
- Assign to a pilot device group.
- Review and create.
- Confirm sensor health and onboarding in Intune and Defender portal.

14.3 Real-world example

Scenario

Intune reports the EDR policy succeeded but Defender portal does not show the device. The engineer checks connector health, licensing, sensor service, onboarding state, proxy/network endpoints, duplicate device records, and last telemetry.

15. Security Baselines

Exact portal path

Microsoft Intune admin center > Endpoint security > Security baselines

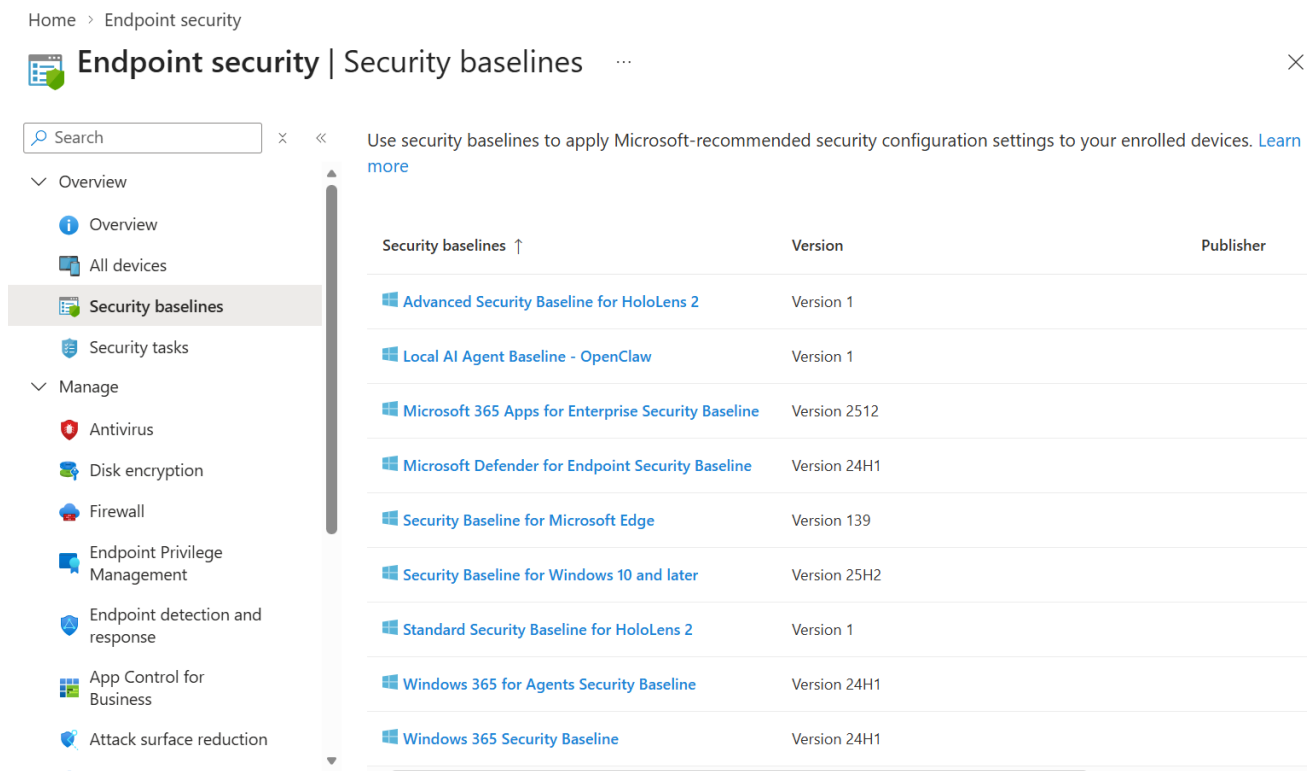
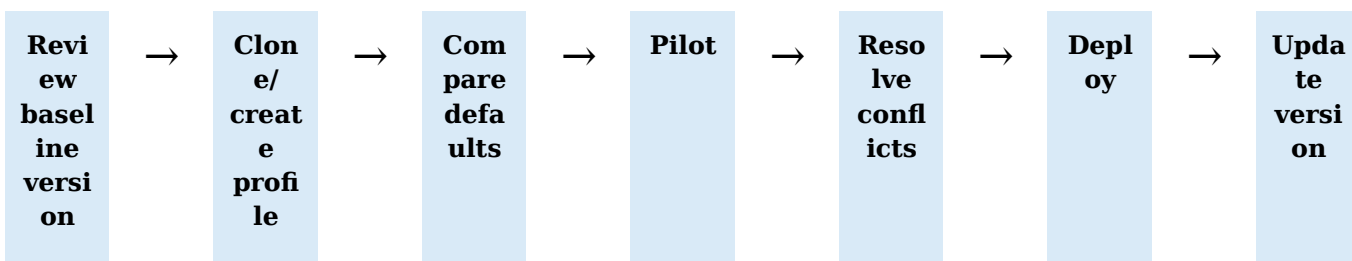


Figure 55. Security baselines inventory with baseline names, versions, and publishers.

15.1 Baseline lifecycle



15.2 Design rules

- Treat the baseline as a starting point, not an automatic production answer.
- Map settings to organizational controls.
- Review user/application impact.
- Avoid configuring the same settings through other policy surfaces.
- When a new baseline version is published, compare and test before updating.

Microsoft documents that a new baseline version replaces the previous version and older profile instances become read-only for setting configuration until updated.



×

Figure 57. Connector configuration and Endpoint Security Profile Settings.

Home > Endpoint security

Endpoint security | Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Search

Refresh

Save

Discard

Delete

Endpoint Privilege Management

Endpoint detection and response

App Control for Business

Attack surface reduction

Account protection

Device compliance

Conditional access

Monitor

Assignment failures

Setup

Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Help and support

Help and support

Compliance policy evaluation

Connect Android devices version 6.0.0 and above to Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Off On

Connect iOS/iPadOS devices version 13.0 and above to Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Off On

Connect Windows devices version 10.0.15063 and above to Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Off On

Enable App Sync (sending application inventory) for iOS/iPadOS devices

Off On

Send full application inventory data on personally owned iOS/iPadOS devices

Off On

Block unsupported OS versions

Off On

App protection policy evaluation

Connect Android devices to Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Off On

Connect iOS/iPadOS devices to Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Off On

Mobile Threat Defense role

Figure 58. Compliance and app-protection evaluation connector options.

Endpoint security | Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Search

Refresh

Save

Discard

Delete

Endpoint Privilege Management

Endpoint detection and response

App Control for Business

Attack surface reduction

Account protection

Device compliance

Conditional access

Monitor

Assignment failures

Setup

Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Help and support

Help and support

App protection policy evaluation

Connect Android devices to Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Off On

Connect iOS/iPadOS devices to Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Off On

Mobile Threat Defense role

Grant MTD role permissions to Microsoft Defender for Endpoint on enrolled Android AM API personally owned with work profile, fully managed, and corporate owned with work profile devices

Off On

Shared settings

Number of days until partner is unresponsive

7

[Open the Microsoft Defender Security Center](#)

Add or remove favorites by pressing Ctrl+Shift+F

Figure 59. Mobile Threat Defense and shared settings continuation.

Internal Master SOP | Endpoint Security Page 64

16.1 Security settings management

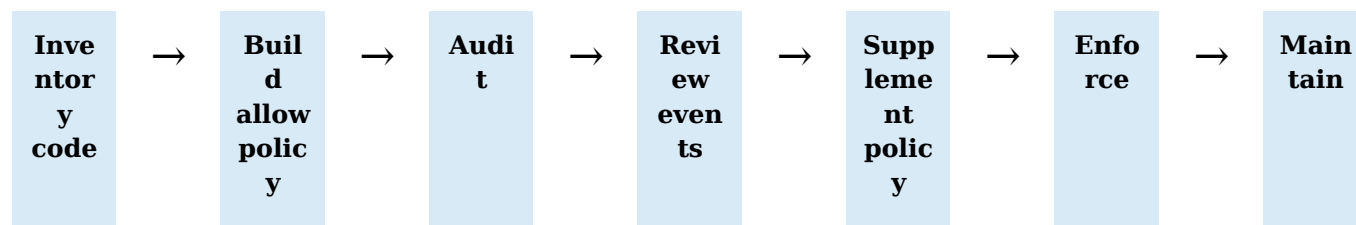
Defender for Endpoint security settings management can extend selected Intune endpoint security policies to supported devices that are onboarded to Defender but not enrolled in Intune. Enrolled Intune devices continue to use Intune MDM policy management.

16.2 Governance

- Define whether each device is Intune-managed or Defender-security-settings-managed.
- Use Entra groups appropriate to the management channel.
- Prevent duplicate policy targeting.
- Monitor status in both Intune and Defender portals.

17. App Control for Business Architecture

App Control for Business manages application control policies so that only trusted code can run according to the organization design. Use audit before enforcement and validate line-of-business applications, installers, scripts, drivers, and update mechanisms.



Real-world example

A line-of-business updater is blocked during pilot. The team validates signer and file reputation, creates a supplemental allow rule, retests upgrades, then resumes phased enforcement.

18. Endpoint Privilege Management Architecture

Endpoint Privilege Management supports least privilege by allowing standard users to run approved processes elevated under controlled rules.

Rule evidence		Example	
Publisher		Signed corporate/vendor application	
File hash		Exact immutable binary	
File name/path		Use cautiously with additional evidence	
User confirmation		Business reason or authentication where supported	

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Elevat
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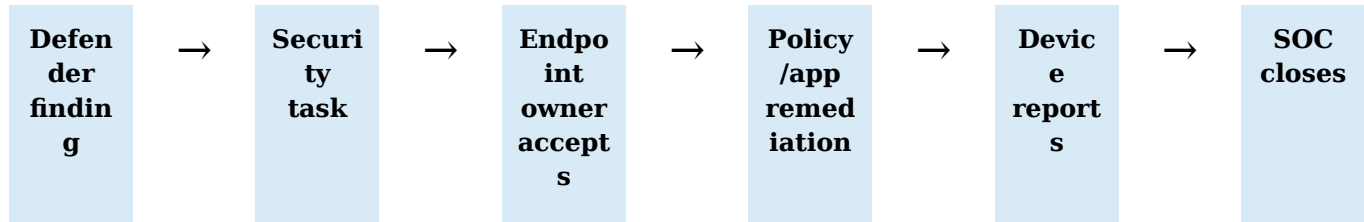
Audit
event

→

Revie
w

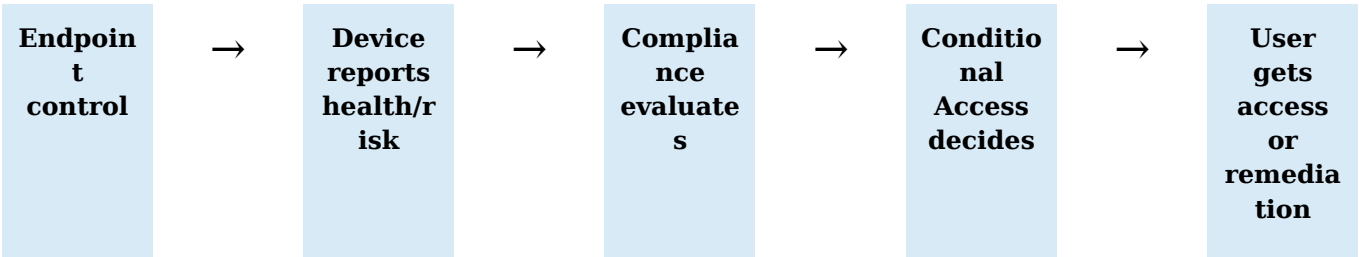
19. Security Tasks and Vulnerability Remediation

Security tasks connect Defender vulnerability findings with Intune remediation activity. Establish ownership between security operations and endpoint engineering.



- Record affected devices and exposure.
- Validate recommended remediation and user impact.
- Pilot configuration or application change.
- Monitor exposure reduction.
- Close only with evidence.

20. Compliance and Conditional Access Integration



- Deploy and validate controls before enforcing access.
- Use Defender machine risk only after connector and onboarding validation.
- Start Conditional Access in report-only mode.
- Exclude emergency access accounts per governance.
- Provide user remediation and support route.

21. Policy Naming Convention

Standard pattern

<Platform>-<Workload>-<Control>-<Scope>-<Environment>-v<Major>.<Minor>

Token	Examples
Platform	WIN, MAC, IOS, AND, LNX
Workload	AV, FW, ENC, ASR, EDR, APPCTRL, ACCT, BASELINE
Control	Realtime, Zscaler, BitLocker, Onboarding, Corporate
Scope	Global, India, Pune, Kiosk
Environment	LAB, PILOT, PROD
Version	v1.0, v1.1, v2.0

WIN-AV-Defender-Global-PROD-v1.0
 WIN-FW-Zscaler-India-PROD-v1.0
 WIN-ENC-BitLocker-Global-PROD-v2.0
 WIN-ASR-Corporate-Global-PILOT-v1.0
 WIN-EDR-Onboarding-Global-PROD-v1.0

22. Assignment, Filters, Scope Tags, and RBAC

- Use Entra groups for deployment scope.
- Use assignment filters only for stable supported attributes.
- Scope tags control administrator visibility, not deployment.
- Use Endpoint Security Manager or a least-privilege custom role.
- Separate policy creation, approval, and production assignment duties where required.



23. Production Rollout Model

Ring	Purpose	Exit evidence
Lab	Validate syntax and platform support	Local state and no critical errors
Security/IT pilot	Validate telemetry and operations	SOC/help-desk readiness
Business pilot	Validate applications and user impact	Accepted exclusions and low incident volume
Production waves	Controlled expansion	Status and incident thresholds met
Broad	Standard estate	Ongoing monitoring and review

24. Conflict Architecture

Conflict source		Example	
Baseline vs endpoint policy		Different Defender or firewall value	
Configuration profile vs endpoint policy		Duplicate BitLocker setting	
Group Policy vs Intune		Domain GPO sets firewall differently	
Multiple endpoint policies		Opposing ASR mode	
Third-party security tool		Defender active/passive-mode assumptions	

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autho
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overla
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→

Sync

→

Valida
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state

25. Incident Response Runbook

1. Confirm alert/detection and device identity.
2. Preserve evidence and follow SOC instructions.
3. Determine whether isolation or containment is approved.
4. Review active malware, EDR, firewall, user, and timeline.
5. Remediate malware/vulnerability or policy gap.
6. Validate sensor/agent health.
7. Restore access only after security approval.
8. Document root cause and preventive change.

26. Troubleshooting Matrix

Symptom	Likely area	Action
AV unhealthy	Service, signatures, passive mode, tamper	Check Defender status and authority
Firewall off	Profile conflict/service/third party	Review profiles and local state
Rule succeeds but app fails	Path, direction, address, port	Validate executable and traffic
Encryption pending	TPM, policy, reboot, recovery escrow	Check local BitLocker and profile
ASR breaks app	Rule mode or exclusion	Audit events and narrow exclusion
EDR not onboarded	Connector, sensor, network, license	Validate both portals and service
Baseline conflict	Duplicate settings	Use per-setting status and choose owner
No Defender data	Connector or onboarding gap	Confirm synchronization and telemetry

26.1 Commands

```
Get-MpComputerStatus
Get-MpPreference
Update-MpSignature
Start-MpScan -ScanType QuickScan
Get-NetFirewallProfile
Get-NetFirewallRule -PolicyStore ActiveStore
manage-bde -status
dsregcmd /status
```

27. Monitoring and Evidence

Evidence	Location
Antivirus health	Endpoint security > Antivirus
Firewall status/rules	Endpoint security > Firewall
Encryption state	Endpoint security > Disk encryption / device recovery keys
EDR onboarding	Endpoint security > EDR and Defender portal
ASR events	Defender portal and Windows event logs
Policy status	Policy > Device and user check-in / per-setting
Security tasks	Endpoint security > Security tasks

27.1 Evidence pack

```
EndpointSecurity/YYYY-MM/
  PolicyExports/
  AssignmentStatus/
  AntivirusHealth/
  FirewallRules/
  EncryptionAndKeys/
  EDRAndASR/
  Incidents/
  Exceptions/
  ExecutiveSummary/
```

28. Real-World Architecture Scenarios

Scenario	Architecture response
Remote laptop	EDR, AV, firewall, BitLocker, cloud compliance, no LAN dependency
Kiosk/shared device	Device-targeted controls, App Control, restricted privilege, no user dependency
Developer workstation	ASR audit, approved exclusions, EPM, App Control pilot
Third-party AV	Define Defender mode and reporting authority; avoid duplicate active engines
Zscaler client	Minimal program/port firewall rules, pilot x86/x64 path, telemetry validation
Server security settings management	Use supported Defender security settings management design and separate groups

29. Interview and Expert Reference

Question	Strong answer
Why Endpoint security policies?	Purpose-built workload profiles with focused settings and reporting.
Baseline vs endpoint policy?	Baseline is a versioned recommended bundle; endpoint policy is focused on a workload.
How prevent conflicts?	One owner per setting and full policy-source inventory.
Audit vs Block for ASR?	Audit measures impact; Block enforces after validation and exclusions.
What does EDR onboarding do?	Connects the endpoint sensor to Defender for telemetry, detection, and response.
Compliance vs security policy?	Security policy configures; compliance evaluates and can feed access decisions.
How validate firewall rule?	Check policy status, local active rule, application path, traffic direction, protocol, ports, addresses, and logs.
Why recovery-key escrow?	Allows approved recovery when protected devices require access restoration.

30. Reusable Design and Incident Records

30.1 Policy record

Field	Record
Policy name/version	
Owner/workload	
Security objective	
Settings and source	
Assignments/exclusions	
Dependencies	
Pilot evidence	
User impact	
Rollback	
Ticket/approval	

30.2 Incident record

Field	Record
Device/user	
Detection/error	
Policy/workload	
Timeline	
Containment	
Root cause	
Remediation	
Validation	
Owner/date	

31. Architect Review Checklist

- Licensing and roles verified.
- Connector and management authority clear.
- No duplicate setting owner.
- Platform and OS support confirmed.
- Pilot and rollback defined.
- AV/firewall/encryption/EDR dependencies validated.
- User and application impact tested.
- Monitoring and incident ownership assigned.
- Exceptions time-bound and approved.
- Evidence and review date recorded.

32. Official References and Maintenance

- Microsoft Learn: Endpoint security in Microsoft Intune - <https://learn.microsoft.com/intune/device-security/endpoint-security-policies>
- Microsoft Learn: Manage endpoint security policies - <https://learn.microsoft.com/intune/device-configuration/endpoint-security/manage-policies>
- Microsoft Learn: Defender security settings management - <https://learn.microsoft.com/intune/device-security/microsoft-defender/security-settings-management>
- Microsoft Learn: Defender for Endpoint security baseline reference - <https://learn.microsoft.com/intune/device-security/security-baselines/ref-defender-settings>

Maintenance rule

Review this SOP after Intune or Defender portal changes, baseline versions, OS support changes, security incidents, connector changes, licensing changes, or major control redesign.